

Naming, Praising, and Shaming Firms: Online Activism and the Russo-Ukrainian War

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Abstract

After the 2022 full-scale Russian invasion of Ukraine, a worldwide movement self-organized to pressure multinational corporations (MNCs) to exit Russia. To study how transnational activists select targets when the digital era meets wartime urgency, we compile 15 online pro-Ukraine “name-praise-shame” lists and match names to over 42,000 MNC subsidiaries present in pre-invasion Russia. After one year, 21.2% are named, with over half of them praised rather than shamed. Activists cannot avoid the strategic problem that if you name everyone, you name no one. We theorize that activists weigh the cost of documenting a firm against the audience attention its naming generates, and we find that high-profile firms are more likely to be named while obscure firms largely escape notice. MNCs that tout social responsibility make especially good targets—and most are praised for keeping their word. One consequence, however, is that naming under-reaches the often-opaque firms tied to the Russian war effort, despite the war’s centrality to the activist mission. The theory is grade-agnostic; we show that the same tradeoffs govern selection whether a name arrives with praise or shame. Even the movement’s own backlash weighs the same tradeoffs for its own audience: the two pro-Russia lists we also collect name largely the same kinds of firms, except those relevant to the war, whose naming loses its payoff when the audience is not pro-Ukraine. Digitalization gives transnational activism speed and scale, but the politics of attention, more than material relevance to the war, determines which firms receive praise, shame, or silence.

Keywords: Naming and shaming; multinational corporations; FDI; social backlash; Russia.

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1 Introduction

When Russia escalated its war against Ukraine with a full-scale invasion in February 2022, governments across Europe and North America retaliated with coordinated sanctions, diplomatic pressure, and direct assistance to Ukraine. Beyond official reactions, the international response was also shaped by non-state actors and civil society, with groups around the globe self-organizing to sway private businesses that continued operations in Russia. Within days, activists began circulating lists of multinational corporations (MNCs), not only naming and shaming firms that remained but also naming and praising those that cut ties. As of one year post-invasion, 15 pro-Ukraine lists named thousands of MNCs, with over half receiving praise, according to novel data in this article. Furthermore, activists have pursued a multifaceted strategy that extends beyond list compilation, including building out dedicated websites, developing social media integrations, stimulating crowdsourcing, designing arresting graphics, and generating global press coverage of their efforts.

This grassroots activism is broader than campaigns that target firms for a specific business practice, as in the 1990s US anti-sweatshop movement (Bartley and Child, 2014); within a specific sector, such as fossil fuels (Bolet, Green and Gonzalez-Eguino, 2024); within a specific home-host dyad, as in the 2012 anti-Japanese movement in China (Tian et al., 2021); or for alleged complicity in violations of international law, as in the pro-Palestine Boycott, Divestment & Sanctions (BDS) Movement (Morrison, 2022). The closest historical parallel is the anti-apartheid movement, which pressured all MNCs to divest from South Africa (Kaempfer, Lehman and Lowenberg, 1987), an analogy pro-Ukraine activists have explicitly invoked.¹ But that movement unfolded in a pre-digital world, spanning the 1960s through South Africa’s 1994 transition. Today’s digitally enabled “social movement repertoire” (Tilly, 2004; Jost et al., 2018) facilitates faster and more coordinated targeting of MNCs in pursuit of broad political causes.

How far did the pro-Ukraine movement’s naming reach? In the pre-digital world of the anti-apartheid movement, activists could not realistically know the universe of possible firm targets. Today, however, business information providers do the work of collecting and integrating data on populations of firms, compiled from official records and investigative research. We approximate the population of eligible targets with a dataset of 42,720 MNC subsidiaries operating in Russia prior to the invasion, which serves as our denominator (Wellhausen and Zhu, 2026). The approximately 9,000 matches between list entries and this pre-invasion sample cover 21.2%. What is the data-generating process through which activists name MNCs operating in Russia? Who is targeted, and who is not?

Even in the digital era, researching firms carries costs, and activists and scholars agree that

¹See, e.g., Sonnenfeld, Jeffrey A., “The Great Business Retreat matters in Russia today—just as it mattered in 1986 South Africa,” *Fortune*, 7 March 2022.

focused campaigns change corporate behavior more effectively than diffuse ones—target everyone, and you target no one (Alinsky, 1971; King, 2008). Our framework holds that activists weigh the cost of documenting a firm against the audience attention its naming generates: will an entry grab the attention not only of the named firm itself but of actors in the social, economic, and political ecosystems available to amplify pressure? Plotting the two considerations against each other, some firm characteristics generate reinforcing combinations, making a firm both cheap to document and attention-grabbing, or both costly to document and unrewarding; other characteristics push the two considerations in opposite directions. Characteristics in reinforcing cells should therefore predict naming more strongly than those in tension cells.

Overall, the theoretical framework’s expectations are largely borne out. Foreign firms in war-relevant industries are more likely to be named, consistent with the movement’s central motivation, but such firms are often opaque and costly to document, resulting in a relatively modest effect size. The consequence is that naming under-reaches the firms most directly tied to Russia’s war effort. Firms with obscure ownership largely escape notice, and results suggest activists deprioritize firms already exposed to state sanctions. The largest effect appears where the framework expects it. Naming concentrates on firms that are cheap to document and attention-grabbing, specifically those in consumer-oriented industries and those from home states politically misaligned with Russia. Most strikingly, good firms make good targets: public commitments to corporate responsibility, measured through United Nations Global Compact (UNGC) membership, are far and away the strongest predictor of naming. Although workhorse proxies for visibility in the literature, firm size and public listing are positive but less meaningful determinants.

We also test whether the same selection logic persists across different forms of activist targeting. First, we separate entities that are named and shamed from those that are named and praised, a possibility overlooked when activists’ efforts are summarized as only “naming and shaming.” In fact, 53.8% of all named entities are praised on at least one pro-Ukraine list. As implied by our grade-agnostic theory, the determinants of naming largely persist whatever the grade attached, and in no case do praise and shame pull significantly in opposite directions. Second, we extend our data collection to the pro-Russia countermovement, scraping two “backlash to backlash” lists that name 5.3% of the pre-invasion sample. Our framework proves flexible enough to explain countermovement selection patterns once we account for the inverted audience; pro-Russia lists are not more likely to name firms relevant to the war.

Our study makes several contributions. First, we document a broad online transnational activist movement that emerged rapidly and moved swiftly to name, praise, and shame MNCs in a target state during a major geopolitical shock. The network spans established organizations, de novo grassroots efforts, and scholar-activists whose lists became the movement’s most public face. Second, we show that even large-scale activism conducted under conditions of wartime urgency is shaped more by the politics

of attention than by the material importance of potential targets. Most notably, public commitments to corporate responsibility predict naming far better than war relevance—a striking result given the campaign’s stated objective of weakening Russia’s capacity to wage war. Finally, our study speaks to the rise of state policies promoting decoupling and supply-chain reorganization, in the Russian context and beyond (e.g., Lee, 2025; Eldes, Lee and Osgood, 2025). When activist and foreign-policy goals coincide, activist pressure may reinforce the “high politics” of economic statecraft.

2 Literature and context

Keck and Sikkink (1998) offer an authoritative account of transnational activism: grassroots actors generate information, build moral authority, and pressure power holders through international solidarity. Digital interdependence has reshaped this “social movement repertoire” (Tilly, 2004; Hall, Schmitz and Dedmon, 2020; Green, 2024; Oppenheimer, 2025; Hulvey and Simmons, 2025). Modern online platforms support petition campaigns (Leonel et al., 2023), recruitment for strategic litigation (Ahlhaus, 2025), crowdsourcing from otherwise hard-to-reach voices (Sumner, Farris and Holman, 2020), the inclusion of non-state actors in political “communities of practice” (Vadrot and Ruiz Rodríguez, 2022), and mobilization for in-person protests (Larson et al., 2019), among other activities.² Social media in particular has supercharged collective action (Jost et al., 2018; Enikolopov, Makarin and Petrova, 2020), including activists’ ability to coordinate pressure on private firms across borders.

Although much social movement theory has focused on challenges to state authority (Smidt et al., 2021), a growing body of scholarship explores how social movements target firms as political actors that can be persuaded or coerced into altering behavior (Soule, 2009; Baron, 2012; Tian et al., 2021). Pressure on firms ranges from formalized mechanisms that monitor and constrain firm behavior, such as private regulatory regimes (Vogel, 2008) and innovative global partnerships (Ruggie, 2013), to less institutionalized forms of social activism (Baron, Harjoto and Jo, 2011; Distelhorst and Locke, 2018). Yet pressuring firms depends on information about them, and gathering it has long been resource-intensive. Consider the anti-apartheid movement calling for MNC divestment with the goal of overturning the regime (Klotz, 1995; Massie, 1997). In 1985 and again in 1988, activists compiled lists of US parent companies and subsidiaries in South Africa and Namibia, sourcing information from upstream activist collections.³ The many people and countless hours that stood behind these lists resulted in the naming of approximately 2,800 distinct US parent companies, subsidiaries, and affiliates.⁴ Yet neither activists

²Literature on Ukrainian censorship (Golovchenko, 2022) and Russian bot activity (Stukal et al., 2022) examines how states intervene in wartime digital spaces; we complement this work by studying transnational activism generated online by non-state actors.

³Knight, Richard, and Roger Walke, *Unified List of United States Companies Doing Business in South Africa and Namibia*, 1st ed. 1985, 2nd ed. 1988 (New York: The Africa Fund), archived by the African Activist Archive, Michigan State University.

⁴Recovered by an AI-assisted process (Appendix A).

then nor we now know the denominator of US or any other foreign firms then operating in South Africa and Namibia.

Compare this monumental, pre-digital effort against our setting. Within one year, a decentralized activist movement built the 15 pro-Ukraine lists collected in our corpus, which we compile into a master list of 9,058 named MNC subsidiaries operating in pre-invasion Russia. Leveraging data from business information providers, we compile a denominator of 42,720 MNC subsidiaries that were operating in Russia prior to the invasion, which in turn allows us to establish the 21.2% naming coverage on which this study is based.⁵ Even today, constructing a denominator is neither costless nor seamless. Activists could nevertheless have pursued complete coverage. In fact, several list makers espoused completeness as their motivation: “every corporation with a presence in Russia must publicly commit to a total cessation of business there,” and “every ruble paid in taxes to Russia turns into deaths and tears of Ukrainian children.”⁶ No corporation and every ruble, and still nearly four in five MNCs in the pre-invasion sample went unnamed. This is evidence of the enduring importance of activist target selection, even more so when the cost curve of gathering firm-level information has shifted massively downward.

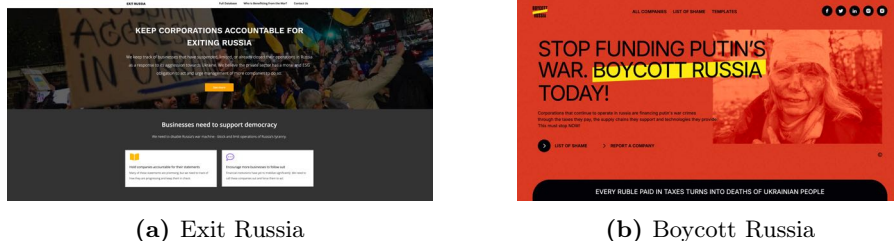
To qualify for inclusion in our corpus, a list has to meet several criteria: (a) name firms individually by their operational status or presence in Russia, in a structured artifact; (b) be publicly available at a URL and accessible during our one-year study window; and (c) be initiated and controlled by non-state actors.⁷ De novo grassroots efforts produced several lists, with titles like “Boycott Russia,” “Don’t Fund War,” “Exit Russia,” and “Squeezing Putin”; established NGOs expanded or reimaged their activities to include others; and lists built by scholar-activists at the Kyiv School of Economics and the Yale School of Management Chief Executive Leadership Institute (CELI) became perhaps the movement’s most public face. Each list in our corpus is a composite object: a dataset of firm entries alongside textual and presentational elements that commonly include information on firms beyond their name, arresting visuals and slogans, social-media integrations, and actionable tools for public participation, such as crowdsourcing forms, pre-written letters to CEOs, or sector-specific sub-campaigns.

Figure 1 illustrates two lists in the corpus: Exit Russia pairs a moral commitment to liberal, democratic principles (e.g., “businesses need to support democracy”) with visuals of a pro-Ukraine rally, while Boycott Russia uses stark imagery and the slogan “every ruble paid in taxes turns into deaths of Ukrainian people.” Detailed list-by-list information and additional visuals are provided in Appendix B. Together, activist websites transform tabular corporate data into pressure instruments aimed at audiences that include the named firms but also actors in the broader public and political environment.

⁵On the construction of the sample, see Appendix C.2 and Wellhausen and Zhu (2026).

⁶Sonnenfeld, Jeffrey A., and Steven Tian, “Some of the Biggest Brands Are Leaving Russia. Others Just Can’t Quit.” *The New York Times*, 8 April 2022 (Appendix B.1.12). RUBusiness homepage slogan (Appendix B.1.8).

⁷Appendix B provides summary information on each list in the corpus, and B.4 provides out-of-scope examples. One edge case that we include is “Stop Bloody Energy,” whose public backers include several Ukrainian energy state-owned enterprises (SOEs) that by implication involve the state and have potential anti-competitive motivations (Appendix B.2.3).



(a) Exit Russia (b) Boycott Russia
Figure 1. Illustrations of pro-Ukraine list homepages

Figure 2 describes the overlap between firms named on the various lists. Like anti-apartheid activists, and consistent with Keck and Sikkink (1998), different activist efforts can be understood as a transnational network in which interrelationship is a feature and not a bug. Nearly all the lists in the corpus emerged online within weeks of the invasion, and activists quickly came to propagate research through the network. As of the one-year anniversary, 74.6% of named firms are on two or more lists.⁸ Still, that one in four firms is named on only one list reflects the ability of a contemporary decentralized movement to sustain more strategic heterogeneity and specialization among the activists operating within it. For example, three smaller lists in the corpus target firms only in the specific sectors of energy and finance.⁹

“Name and shame” misdescribes these groups, which more often “name, praise, and shame.” Even pre-digital anti-apartheid lists of the 1980s already contained an implicit praise component, separately naming and categorizing firms that had left South Africa and Namibia. The Wikipedia list in our corpus similarly categorizes firms’ exits from Russia and contributions to Ukraine’s war effort, inviting readers to infer both praise and shame.¹⁰ Eleven pro-Ukraine lists go further, explicitly grading praiseworthy firms, using a credit-rating-style “AAA” badge and social media prompts to “Show your support!” for exiting firms.¹¹ The Yale CELI list introduced an A-to-F grading scheme that spread as other list makers adopted or adapted it.¹² Praise dominates our dataset: 53.8% of named MNC subsidiaries received the top grade on at least one pro-Ukraine list.

Lists and grades are longstanding tools in international politics. Research shows that formal international organizations and other non-state actors rank states with performance indicators, praising those at the top and shaming those at the bottom (Merry, Davis and Kingsbury, 2015; Kelley and Simmons, 2020).¹³ By clarifying behavioral norms and focal points for collective action, lists reduce coordination frictions. Other scholarship examines firms seeking grades through certifications and clubs whose standards they accept (Potoski and Prakash, 2005; Bartley, 2007).¹⁴ Advocacy agenda-setting

⁸To allow a buffer, we scrape lists as of 31 March 2023.

⁹Defuel Russia’s War (Appendix B.2.1), Putin 100 (B.2.2), and Stop Bloody Energy (B.2.3).

¹⁰Wikipedia (Appendix B.1.11).

¹¹RUBusiness (Appendix B.1.8), Coalition for Ukraine (B.1.2).

¹²Yale CELI (Appendix B.1.12).

¹³How do they choose targets? Koliev and Lebovic (2018) use the International Labour Organization to theorize that the data-generating process for naming is separate from choices over priorities within the named set.

¹⁴Firms also grade other firms, creating profit motivations on both sides of the relationship (Chatterji and Toffel, 2010).

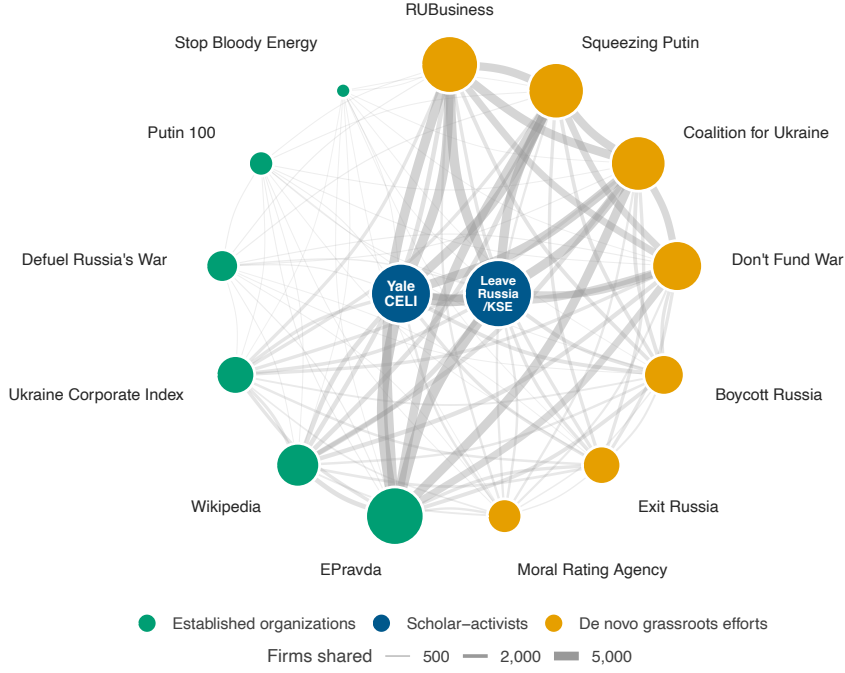


Figure 2. Network of 15 pro-Ukraine lists.

research shows that transnational issue attention is contested; many candidate issues never emerge (Carpenter, 2007). Here, however, Russia’s full-scale invasion resolved that contest within days, with activists as first movers in deciding which firms to grade.

Social movement scholarship gives us reason to expect countermobilization as movements gain traction (Meyer and Staggenborg, 1996), while Bob (2012) reminds us that transnational activism spans competing political persuasions. The pro-Ukraine “name, praise, and shame” movement was no exception. The Chinese ride-hailing platform Didi made global headlines when it reversed its announced exit from Russia after heated criticism on Chinese social media accusing it of capitulating to US pressure. Lenovo encountered parallel pushback and quickly denied a viral Belarusian news report announcing its exit. Russian-language Telegram channels and domestic Russian social media were heated as more MNCs announced plans that garnered praise from pro-Ukraine activists.

The pro-Russia “transnational backlash” mirrored the pro-Ukraine movement’s institutional forms, providing an out-of-sample confirmation of Velasco (2023), which finds similar parallelism in gender politics. Our second corpus comprises two pro-Russia lists. We’ll Remember Everything (#BCE-ЗАПОМНИМ) urged Russian audiences to remember firms that had exited and boycott them if they

returned.¹⁵ Its badges classified firms’ behavior, from “respect” to “screwed over” and “[used] obscene language.”¹⁶ We also scrape a list compiled by Kommersant, Russia’s leading business newspaper, whose reporting mirrors the Ukrainian newspaper EPravda’s list.¹⁷ Together, the two pro-Russia lists name 25.0% of the firms appearing on pro-Ukraine lists, allowing us to test whether they adopted only the movement’s structure or also its targeting strategies.¹⁸

What does the literature predict about the targeting strategies of the pro-Ukraine “name, praise, and shame” list makers? Scholarship on whether normatively motivated activists can change firm behavior finds conditional effects (e.g., Kapstein and Busby, 2016; Chrun, Berliner and Prakash, 2018; Lee, 2024). In the context of the Russo-Ukrainian war, emerging research finds nuanced evidence of social pressure effectiveness on executives’ attitudes (Davis, Li and Miyano, 2024), stock market returns (Balyuk and Fedyk, 2023), exit announcements (Pham, 2025), and realized exits (Wellhausen and Zhu, 2026). Activists’ continued pressure nonetheless implies that they derive utility from it.¹⁹ Identifying goals beyond their stated mission is therefore important. Whereas foundational literature has emphasized NGOs’ interests in organizational persistence and growth (Cooley and Ron, 2002), decentralized online activists may see outcomes like publicity for the cause, uptake in the legacy media, evidence of financial or reputational harm to target firms, and other more generalized concepts of increased awareness as primary goals (Bennett and Segerberg, 2013; Karpf, 2016). The literature provides at least conditional support for the idea that such efforts to shape public opinion can ultimately influence firm behavior (McDonnell and Werner, 2016; Sumner, 2022; Moehlecke, Fasolin and Spektor, 2025).

We view pro-Ukraine “name, praise, and shame” list makers as addressing broad and multifaceted audiences, ranging from the CEOs making corporate decisions over investments in Russia to the social and political ecosystems in which firms exist and through which activist efforts may be amplified. In developing our theory below, we draw on rich literatures that inform expectations over which firms make good targets. Our key contribution is to develop and refine hypotheses under circumstances that produce a sharp, time-sensitive, and enormous goal—combatting the Russian war effort—in an era in which it is more possible than ever that “a wealth of information creates a poverty of attention” (Simon, 1971).

3 Theory

The pro-Ukraine name-praise-shame movement sought to weaken Russia’s war effort by reducing foreign investment and business activity in the country. Boycott Russia describes a “funnel of funding

¹⁵Appendix B.3.2.

¹⁶A “mood of the people” feature also invited users to register their feelings through three emojis, labeled “well ok,” “a bit sad,” and “I’m angry.”

¹⁷Kommersant (Appendix B.3.1); EPravda (B.1.4).

¹⁸The five exceptions named only on pro-Russia lists are firms that cut Russian access to software and cloud services (Section 5.2; Appendix B.3.2).

¹⁹On overcoming an activist “despondency trap” regarding corporate accountability, see Evans (2020).

Russia: doing business → paying taxes & supporting the economy → funding the war machine.”²⁰ Taken seriously, this logic makes virtually any firm operating in Russia a potential target. Yet activists cannot direct equal attention to every eligible firm: broad targeting dilutes impact, since attention directed at everyone reaches no one. As Hafner-Burton (2008) puts it, organizations “shine the spotlight selectively.” Saul Alinsky offered the canonical strategic advice in *Rules for Radicals*: “Pick the target, freeze it, personalize it, and polarize it” (Alinsky, 1971). Groups in our sample confronted the same problem. One Wikipedia contributor warned that a proposed methodology would “encompass all companies worldwide,” including “any coffee shop that put up a poster,” thereby “reducing the page’s utility.”²¹ Target selection is thus unavoidable, and especially consequential in an information environment capable of counting every coffee shop that displays a poster.

We conceptualize this choice along two dimensions (Figure 3). *Cost* captures the resources required to document a firm’s presence in Russia and add it to a list. Technology has shifted the cost distribution curve downward (Earl and Kimport, 2011), but firms still vary in how easily their names and activities can be identified. We simplify this heterogeneity as high versus low costs. Second, the *Audience attention* axis captures the expected return from including a given firm: the extent to which its inclusion can attract actors in the social, economic, and political ecosystems that amplify pressure on the firm, spur peer pressure, or raise attention to the movement more broadly. Firms with built-in narrative hooks or preexisting audiences garner more audience attention. By contrast, obscure firms are unlikely to resonate, while firms already entrenched in the “wrongdoer” category may generate little additional attention from being named.

Figure 3. Activist tradeoffs: Summary of hypotheses predicting selection onto lists.

		<i>Audience attention</i>	
		More	Less
<i>Cost</i>	High	H1: War relevance (↓↑)	H5: Obscure ownership (↓↓)
		H2: Potential hypocrisy (↑↑)	
	Low	H3: Visibility (↑↑)	H6: Pre-invasion sanctions (↑↓)
		H4: Home–Russia misalignment (↑↑)	

Plotting *Cost* against *Audience attention* organizes hypotheses H1–H6 about firm characteristics that predict naming on lists (Figure 3). The resulting 2x2 also highlights that some firm characteristics are mutually reinforcing, suggesting a higher probability of naming, whereas other characteristics occupy off-diagonal cells where theoretical mechanisms pull in opposite directions. This motivates H7, which concerns effect sizes: reinforcing characteristics should be more consistent and larger-magnitude predictors of naming, whether positive or negative, than characteristics situated in cells marked by theoretical

²⁰Appendix B.1.1.

²¹Appendix B.1.11.

tension.

3.1 War relevance

If the pro-Ukraine name-praise-shame movement seeks to constrain Russia’s war effort, firms integral to war-making should receive highest priority. Activists’ broadest mission concerns “every ruble” contributed by MNCs in Russia; within that universe, activists make inferences over which ruble has the greatest marginal contribution. Yet war-relevant firms are difficult to identify. States have imposed extensive sanctions intended to impede Russia’s war effort, but the Russian military has persisted. If states with coercive power struggle to target firms by war relevance, activists should face even greater difficulties. Our own coding illustrates the problem. We proxy war-relevant four-digit NAICS industries using five sources: U.S. Department of Defense procurement contracts (Omari et al., 2025); the European Union (EU) dual-use control list; the 2020 SIPRI Top-100 arms-producing and military-services firms; Russian industries requiring official approval for foreign investment on national-security grounds; and Russian industries designated “systemically important” and eligible for state support.²² These sources flag 170 industries, but unevenly: 82 are identified by only one source and five by all (electric power generation; engines and turbines; aerospace; ship and boat building; computer systems design). We combine them into INDUSTRY RELEVANT TO WAR, a latent measure estimated by iterated principal factor analysis.²³ We expect a positive association with naming, but the costs of identifying war relevance should attenuate its magnitude (H7).

Assigning war relevance to firms is nearly costless for us but highly resource-intensive for activists. We link firms to specified industries with a simple line of code; activists must investigate and document activities often hidden in opaque, military-adjacent supply chains. For example, it took more than a year for investigative reporting to reveal that 25 European companies were still supplying Russian defense contractors. Although their transactions did not technically violate sanctions, these firms were clear high-priority targets for activist pressure that remained unidentified because of search costs.²⁴ War relevance is therefore central to the pro-Ukraine movement but occupies the *high-cost* row in Figure 3, creating a tradeoff that should lead activists to deprioritize otherwise highly relevant firms.

Hypothesis 1 *MNCs operating in industries relevant to the war effort are more likely to be selected onto lists.*

²²Definitions, thresholds, and crosswalks appear in Appendix D.1.

²³Appendix Table E3 substitutes each component for the composite.

²⁴“BuZiness as usual: 25 European companies still supplying the Russian army,” *The Insider*, 17 May 2023. None of these firms are named on the lists in our corpus.

3.2 Potential hypocrisy

Activists have reinforcing motivations to name businesses that garner *more audience attention* while remaining findable at *low cost* (Figure 3). A paradoxical class of firms that fall in this cell are “good firms” that are credibly aligned with activist goals (Soule, 2009; Baron and Diermeier, 2007; Thrall, 2021; DesJardine, Marti and Durand, 2021). Firms that invest in corporate social responsibility (CSR) and environment, social, and governance (ESG) initiatives may be particularly susceptible to activist pressure when they deviate from their commitments, because those public commitments provide leverage for criticism (King and McDonnell, 2015). This paradox might lead “good firms” to invest even more in CSR/ESG efforts in order to preempt criticism, creating a virtuous cycle from the activists’ viewpoint (Potoski and Prakash, 2005; Malhotra, Monin and Tomz, 2019).

The lists in our corpus engage extensively with firms’ ethical claims. Exit Russia states its goal as ensuring “that corporates are accountable for walking their talk,” while Boycott Russia’s template CEO letter describes continued operations as “blatant hypocrisy that needs to be called out” and “in breach of fundamental ethical and ESG standards.”²⁵

Among CSR initiatives, the UN Global Compact (UNGC) is especially salient. Launched by the UN Secretary-General in 2000, the UNGC is a voluntary initiative in which firms commit to ten principles spanning human rights, labor standards, environmental responsibility, and anti-corruption; it is arguably the world’s most prominent corporate sustainability initiative (Bernhagen and Mitchell, 2010; Thrall, 2021). Membership publicly associates firms with normative benchmarks against which activists can evaluate their conduct. Its salience for activist listing thus follows the broader logic of visibility and accountability: foreign-invested firms that publicly commit to a UN-sanctioned principles framework are more exposed than those that do not, both because the commitment is internationally visible and because it provides activists with a credible standard against which to judge behavior. While no list in the corpus explicitly mentions the UNGC, we use it as a proxy for high-visibility firms that have made public commitments that expose them to scrutiny and, potentially, charges of hypocrisy (Berliner and Prakash, 2015). UNGC SIGNATORY is coded as 1 if an MNC subsidiary belonged to the corporate orbit of a UNGC signatory active as of 31 December 2021, and 0 otherwise (Appendix D.2).

Hypothesis 2 *MNCs that are UN Global Compact (UNGC) signatories are more likely to be selected onto lists.*

²⁵Exit Russia (Appendix B.1.5), Boycott Russia (B.1.1).

3.3 Visibility

A firm’s visibility to the public shapes both whether activists can find it and whether naming it will land (Bartley and Child, 2014; Sumner, 2022; Qin et al., 2025). We measure visibility in three ways: consumer orientation, size, and public listing, each of which places firms in the *more audience attention*, *low cost* cell of Figure 3.

3.3.1 Consumer orientation

Mass-market firms attract attention because consumers know and buy their products, making strategic decisions salient and facilitating activist mobilization (Bartley, 2007; Bartley and Child, 2014). This audience underlies research on “political consumerism” (Micheletti, Føllesdal and Stolle, 2004; Kam and Deichert, 2020), including consumer activism related to international conflict and war (Pandya and Venkatesan, 2016; Helms, Pandya and Venkatesan, 2025). Media likewise favor recognizable, consumer-facing brands (Graf-Vlachy et al., 2020). Their visibility makes market entry and divestment difficult to conceal, encouraging public announcements for reputation management (Fombrun and Shanley, 1990), while scrutiny heightens incentives for transparency (King and Soule, 2007). Uniqlo illustrates these dynamics. When its CEO defended continuing Russian operations because “clothing is a necessity of life” and “the people of Russia have the same right to live as we do,” public attention and outcry followed immediately. Days later, Uniqlo reversed course and announced a suspension of Russian operations, generating further press coverage.²⁶ Consumer-facing MNCs are therefore attractive targets: their activities are cheap to document, and their brands provide ready-made audiences for mobilization.

To measure consumer orientation, we use advertising intensity as a financially grounded proxy for consumer relevance (Peterson and Su, 2017). We draw on the best-available data from the US IRS Corporation Source Book (2013), disaggregated by industry at the three-digit NAICS level.²⁷ CONSUMER-ORIENTED INDUSTRY equals 1 if a firm operates in an industry with above-median advertising intensity across industries, and 0 otherwise.

Hypothesis 3a *MNCs in consumer-oriented industries are more likely to be selected onto lists.*

3.3.2 Size

Size predicts audience attention and lower documentation costs, both directly and through correlated factors such as name recognition and extensive stakeholder networks (Bartley and Child, 2014). Large firms are also attractive targets because their behavior carries greater symbolic and material

²⁶“Uniqlo to continue selling clothes in Russia,” *Nikkei Asia*, 8 March 2022. “Uniqlo bows to public pressure to close stores in Russia,” *CBS News*, 10 March 2022.

²⁷Comparable Russian data are unavailable; we assume consumer orientation is primarily an industry characteristic rather than the result of country-specific policy interventions.

weight, generating headlines, signaling reputational costs to peers, and giving activists evidence of influence (Lenox and Eesley, 2009; van der Ven, 2018). Smaller firms are less salient, harder to monitor, and less likely to provide leverage. Larger MNC subsidiaries also contribute disproportionately to host economies through jobs, added value, and tax revenues (Auriol and Warlters, 2005). Their embeddedness in local production networks and fiscal structures makes their presence or absence especially consequential for government capacity and economic stability, and thus especially salient to audiences seeking to weaken the host state.

Size features prominently across the corpus. Yale CELI requires named firms to have roughly USD 100 million in global revenue; LeaveRussia/KSE excludes firms below roughly USD 5 million in annual revenue while prioritizing “top taxpayers in Russia”; and Putin 100 explicitly targets “Putin’s 100 BIGGEST bankrollers.”²⁸ To operationalize FIRM SIZE, we use four categories: small, medium, large, and very large, defined by the combination of a Russian MNC subsidiary’s revenues and employee footprint.²⁹

Hypothesis 3b *Larger MNC subsidiaries in Russia are more likely to be selected onto lists.*

3.3.3 Public listing

Publicly listed MNCs face stronger incentives than private firms to maintain visibility and reputation. Their dispersed shareholders have a direct financial stake in the firm, while capital-market scrutiny makes them particularly sensitive to reputational shocks: stock prices respond to negative publicity, governance concerns, and perceived failures of corporate responsibility (Vasi and King, 2012; Goranova and Ryan, 2014; Krüger, 2015; King and Soule, 2007; Ahlquist and Mosley, 2021). Public firms also rely on equity markets for future investment, making visibility and legitimacy central to corporate strategy (Fombrun and Shanley, 1990; Ioannou and Serafeim, 2015). Negative publicity or inclusion on activist name-praise-shame lists can therefore affect reputation and financing. Additionally, many jurisdictions legally require publicly listed firms to disclose information about their business operations, governance structures, and financial performance. Securities regulation regimes such as the US Securities and Exchange Commission or EU directives on non-financial disclosure mandate a baseline of transparency that makes public MNCs more visible to external audiences, including activists and NGOs.

Moral Rating Agency, a list in our sample, records each firm’s listing status and states that its ratings “will be particularly powerful for publicly-traded companies.” Stop Bloody Energy makes the link explicit: “We will show your shareholders how many Ukrainians their money has murdered.”³⁰

²⁸Yale CELI (Appendix B.1.12), LeaveRussia/KSE (B.1.6), Putin 100 (B.2.2).

²⁹Categories as defined in the Orbis database, discussed in Appendix D.2. As our unit of analysis is each MNC subsidiary in Russia, what might be a large global parent can own local Russian subsidiaries of any of a variety of sizes. We account for the parent through other estimation choices.

³⁰Stop Bloody Energy campaign infographic (Appendix B.2.3).

To examine this targeting logic quantitatively, we code an observation as PUBLICLY TRADED if the firm’s largest shareholder and/or its ultimate parent company is listed on any stock exchange outside Russia.

Hypothesis 3c *Publicly traded MNCs are more likely to be selected onto lists.*

3.4 Home–Russia misalignment

A firm’s home state shapes both sides of the activist tradeoff, placing MNCs from states politically misaligned with Russia in the *low cost, more audience attention* cell of Figure 3. On the cost side, when an MNC’s foreign investment is potentially scandalous at home, journalists, politicians, and watchdogs have independent incentives to investigate, allowing list makers to harvest information from an existing scrutiny ecosystem. No comparable ecosystem exists in aligned states, where an MNC’s foreign investment is not itself politically controversial. In our setting, misaligned states are also overwhelmingly open-records democracies, where corporate registries, disclosure requirements, and free presses make ownership, headquarters, and Russian operations relatively easier to establish.

Domestic audiences have a greater stake in seeing firms from their own countries named. Naming a firm from a misaligned home state converts the distant cause of Ukraine’s defense into a domestic political question, which raises mobilizing potential (Keck and Sikkink, 1998; Benford and Snow, 2000). Such firms also provide a ready-made narrative of inconsistency: activists expose the gap between government policy and corporate practice. As governments increasingly use trade, investment, and firms as foreign-policy instruments, publics likewise understand commerce as interstate conflict (Baldwin, 1985; Farrell and Newman, 2019; Clayton, Maggiori and Schreger, 2026). Two features heighten this salience. First, the anti-Russia coalition is predominantly democratic, making public preferences more consequential (Guriev and Treisman, 2020). Second, coalition-state publics include Ukrainian diasporas swelled by millions of refugees since the invasion, creating an audience with an especially direct stake in the outcome.

We measure HOME–RUSSIA MISALIGNMENT with three components, mirroring the strategy behind our war relevance measure that combines general data sources with Russia’s own official designations. First, we use the home state’s UNGA voting dissimilarity with Russia, averaged over 2017-2021 (Bailey, Strezhnev and Voeten, 2017). Second, we use V-Dem’s Liberal Democracy Index, also averaged over 2017-2021 (Coppedge et al., 2020). Third, we use a dichotomous indicator of whether the home state appears on the Russian government’s “Unfriendly Countries” list, introduced nine days after the full-scale invasion to designate jurisdictions that Russia characterizes as having taken hostile measures against it, its firms, or its citizens.³¹ The three components are correlated with one another; we combine them into

³¹Список недружественных стран, Appendix D.2.

a single standardized score using iterated principal factor analysis.³²

Hypothesis 4 *MNCs from states that are politically misaligned with Russia are more likely to be selected onto lists.*

3.5 Obscure ownership

Ownership structures can discourage targeting, placing MNCs with obscure ownership in the *high cost, less audience attention* cell of Figure 3. On the cost side, establishing ultimate ownership of a firm can require tracing chains of holding companies across registries, trustees, and foundations, and those chains are often opaque by design (Findley, Nielson and Sharman, 2014; Zucman, 2015). Even well-resourced scholarly researchers struggle to trace complex ownership networks (Earle et al., 2022). On the audience attention side, firms with opaque ownership structures are characterized by complex, multi-jurisdictional layering that obscures or dilutes their apparent nationality, thereby reducing the likelihood of attracting high levels of audience attention.

The corpus’s two largest lists have explicit methodologies that screen based on obscure ownership. Yale CELI requires a verifiable business presence “beyond appearing as an entity on a legal registry,” and LeaveRussia/KSE deliberately excludes “companies with Russian final beneficiaries,” although it also considers strategic importance for the Russian economy and military production, “which specifically explains why KSE includes some smaller and more obscure companies” (Sonnenfeld et al., 2023). The salience of these rules surfaced in a public dispute over a working paper conducting positivist analysis of the exiting Russia movement.³³ Yale–KSE rejected the working paper’s denominator as containing “not real foreign companies,” asking, “Can Rusal really pull out of Russia? The answer, of course, is no” (Sonnenfeld et al., 2023). The denominator in our study also includes Rusal, which qualifies as an MNC because it has subsidiaries incorporated in Jersey and Cyprus. Similarly, Miratorg, Russia’s major meat producer; Dixy, a food retailer with thousands of stores across Russia; and the footwear chain Kari all have Cyprus or British Virgin Islands ownership prior to the invasion at the 10% or higher level, which also qualifies them as FDI and means they enter our sample. We take it as a feature of contemporary globalization that the population of MNCs includes firms that observers might otherwise understand as domestic, and test whether the name-praise-shame movement as a whole shared the Yale CELI and LeaveRussia/KSE impulse to bypass such firms as targets.

We operationalize obscure ownership in two ways. First, we isolate firms registered in tax havens. To identify tax havens, we rely on the EU list of non-cooperative tax jurisdictions. This approach implies that no EU member state is classified as a tax haven. Given broad expert consensus that Cyprus serves

³²Appendix D.2. In Appendix Table E3, each of the three components enters separately in place of the composite.

³³January 2023 working-paper version of Evenett and Pisani (2023).

as a key offshore destination for Russian capital (Ledyaeva et al., 2015; Logvinenko, 2021), we classify it as a tax haven as well.³⁴ HOME IS TAX HAVEN equals 1 if the firm’s controlling shareholder or parent company is incorporated in a tax-haven jurisdiction, and 0 otherwise.

Hypothesis 5a *MNCs originating from tax havens are less likely to be selected onto lists.*

Second, FDI “roundtripping” refers to capital routed through a foreign entity after erstwhile domestic investors incorporate abroad (Linsi and Mügge, 2019). For activists, the movement’s central narrative may fail for these firms: there is no clearly misaligned home government for the firm to contradict and no domestic audience for activists to persuade. How to isolate roundtrippers within FDI data is a topic of debate (Aykut, Sanghi and Kosmidou, 2017). Our approach is to tag MNC subsidiaries whose ownership profiles suggest that capital originating in Russia is running through a foreign entity. Specifically, we code a firm as a likely roundtripper if its parent (global ultimate owner) is Russian. Sometimes, parent-level ownership information is unavailable in our dataset; in that case, we also code as a likely roundtripper a firm whose only documented foreign ownership is via a tax haven.³⁵

Hypothesis 5b *MNCs consisting of roundtripped Russian capital are less likely to be selected onto lists.*

3.6 Pre-invasion sanctions

What characteristics locate a firm in the *low cost, less audience attention* cell of Figure 3? These are firms that could add bloat to an activist project and compromise public uptake of the activist mission. While documenting them is low cost, they are unlikely to capture audience attention and thus could dilute efforts.

We hypothesize that firms exposed to Russia-related sanctions prior to the full-scale invasion are in this cell.

Sanctions are codified and visible by design, so that sanction-senders can inform third parties to sever ties with sanctioned entities. However, we expect audience attention and payoff from activist re-naming of sanctioned firms to be low. For public audiences, sanctions have already generated the information and mobilization that activist naming might otherwise provide. For economic actors, sanctions can compel counterparties within the sender’s jurisdiction to sever ties; activist lists can only encourage them to do so informally. If naming a sanctioned firm is redundant rather than additive, activists gain more by directing scarce audience attention elsewhere. Indeed, list makers highlight how their efforts are distinct from the formal sanctions regime. In particular, the original name of the LeaveRussia/KSE project was “SelfSanctions.”³⁶

³⁴See Appendix D.3, Table D2, for the full list.

³⁵Of MNC subsidiaries with tax-haven homes, 19.1% are also coded as likely roundtrippers. No firm with state ownership is coded as a likely roundtripper.

³⁶LeaveRussia/KSE (Appendix B.1.6).

We match MNC subsidiaries in our pre-invasion sample to official sanctions lists, themselves compiled by the non-profit OpenSanctions. We filter to the pre-invasion period and take the union of entities under Russia-, Ukraine-, and Belarus-related sanctions; the data include sanctions from the US, the EU, the UK, Australia, Canada, and Ukraine. Designations start in 1997, with the large majority emerging following Russia’s 2014 annexation of Crimea. PRE-INVASION SANCTIONS is coded as 1 based on the name of the MNC subsidiary itself, another subsidiary in the corporate family, and/or the parent company.³⁷ Of the pre-invasion sample, 3.8% are matched through this procedure. We make no claim as to the nature of the sanction to which name-based matched entities are exposed.

Hypothesis 6 *MNCs exposed to pre-invasion sanctions are less likely to be selected onto lists.*

3.7 Relative magnitudes

Figure 3 sorts the MNC characteristics behind H1 through H6 into cells where cost and audience attention reinforce or oppose one another. Potential hypocrisy (H2), visibility (H3a–H3c), and Home–Russia misalignment (H4) fall where documentation is cheap and attention high, so both favor naming. Obscure ownership (H5a, H5b) falls where documentation is costly and attention low, so both disfavor it. In these reinforcing cells, the two considerations push decentralized list makers toward the same choice, allowing associations to accumulate across the corpus. War relevance and pre-invasion sanctions occupy off-diagonal cells, where cost and attention push in opposite directions. This tension does not determine the net direction of the effect; the hypotheses specify the predicted sign. We expect list makers to document war-relevant firms (H1) but, on net, to avoid documenting sanctioned firms (H6). Because cost and attention conflict, however, list makers may resolve the tradeoff differently across lists. The observable implication is that reinforcing mechanisms should have larger absolute associations with naming than mechanisms characterized by internal tension.

Hypothesis 7 *MNC characteristics in cells where audience attention and cost reinforce ($\uparrow\uparrow$, $\downarrow\downarrow$) have larger absolute effects on selection onto lists than characteristics in cells where the factors oppose ($\downarrow\uparrow$, $\uparrow\downarrow$).*

4 Empirics

We treat the 15 pro-Ukraine lists as a comprehensive corpus of the online name-praise-shame movement at the invasion’s one-year anniversary.³⁸ Appendix B details each list’s origin, goals, methods, sources, slogans, and presentation. Although all seek to persuade businesses to leave Russia, they differ

³⁷Appendix D.4.

³⁸Appendix B.4 discusses related activity outside our scope.

in how closely they screen for FDI versus other economic ties. For example, a number of lists name firms that were engaged only in trade with Russia, or non-commercial actors such as international sports and hobby groups with scheduled Russian events.³⁹ However, because the movement principally seeks corporate exits, we use an FDI-defined sample to establish a denominator within its core target universe.

Firm-name matching presents well-known challenges, especially across languages and alphabets. We first encounter this problem in merging the lists into one, which is necessary to characterize the transnational network as a whole (Figure 2). We use human and AI-assisted research to make decisions over whether an entry on one list is intended to be the same as an entry on another. Where intent is uncertain, entries remain distinct canonicals; avoiding over-merging preserves recall in downstream firm-name matching. This process leads to a combined list of approximately 5,300 canonicals.

We match canonical names to a pre-invasion sample of 42,720 foreign firms in Russia at end-2021, drawn from Bureau van Dijk’s Orbis Historical databases and comprehensive against available benchmarks (Wellhausen and Zhu, 2026). Inclusion requires at least 10% direct or indirect foreign ownership, consistent with international FDI standards. The unit is an MNC subsidiary engaged in FDI. As detailed in Appendix C.1, we use human-in-the-loop, AI-assisted procedures to match names at either the subsidiary or parent level. We accept substantial name overlap even when the entry may not be the intended target, since similarly named firms may be conflated by audiences.⁴⁰ We propagate matches through corporate families, assuming that naming one entity affects commonly owned affiliates.⁴¹ We preserve every decision, allowing reconstruction without rerunning AI assistance (Appendix C.1), and apply the same procedure to construct UNGC SIGNATORY and PRE-INVASION SANCTIONS (Appendices D.2, D.4).

The entries on pro-Ukraine name-praise-shame lists match to 9,058 MNC subsidiaries, or 21.2% of the pre-invasion sample, which is the basis for our dependent variable. The main reasons for the difference between the list-derived canonical count and the matched count are that lists include entries not engaged in FDI that therefore would never match, and that our propagation procedures allow one activist list entry to match multiple MNC subsidiaries in the pre-invasion sample. The mean matched MNC subsidiary is on 5.35 lists, with a standard deviation of 3.83. Subsidiaries in the corporate families of Citigroup, Goldman Sachs, and JPMorgan Chase match to 14 of 15 lists. We run estimations excluding single-list matches to address the possibility that false positives are concentrated there; 25.4% of matches are of this type.

³⁹The Insider’s 2026 SanctionsEvasionTracker extends activist naming beyond FDI to supply chain ties, identifying thousands of exporters to sanctioned Russian firms or defense suppliers.

⁴⁰For example, Crocs, Inc. is an American footwear company, and CROC is a Russian IT/systems integration company. We expect that one is regularly mistaken for the other.

⁴¹For example, the canonical Haval Motor, a Chinese auto company, directly matches to the MNC subsidiary Haval Motors Russia Ltd, which is owned by the parent Baoding Innovation, which in turn has two other subsidiaries (with different names) in Russia. All three MNC subsidiaries are matched.

As shown in Appendix C.2, naming is distributed unevenly across observable dimensions. Named MNC subsidiaries appear in every industry and every size category. No group approaches full coverage; even among very large firms, the best-covered category, only 42.7% are named. Named MNC subsidiaries originate in 82 of the 132 home jurisdictions; the top three are Germany, France, and Cyprus.

4.1 Specification

In our main results, the dependent variable equals 1 if a firm observation in the pre-invasion data is matched to any of the 15 pro-Ukraine lists, and zero otherwise. For easy interpretation, we estimate linear probability models.⁴² We include two-digit NAICS industry fixed effects to account for unobserved industry heterogeneity. At the home level, controls include the state’s bilateral trade with Russia calculated as the 2017-2021 average (Conte, Cotterlaz and Mayer, 2022). We also control for firms originating from Ukraine, presuming that activist interests in engaging them are systematically different. At the firm level, we control for whether a firm has state ownership, presuming that whether the home state has a financial stake in a firm might affect activist decision-making.⁴³ We also control for the firm’s embeddedness in Russia through its corporate family presence, which is the (logged) count of the parent’s subsidiaries in Russia, and years since incorporation (logged, capped at 1991). Some observations enter the Orbis dataset because of FDI-level foreign ownership at the parent level, not at the subsidiary level; we include an indicator controlling for this situation. We also include indicator variables for firms with multiple qualifying FDI-level owners and multiple home states.⁴⁴ Standard errors are two-way clustered by home and corporate family.

5 Results

Table 1 reports our main results. Model 1 includes only covariates of interest, Model 2 is fully specified, and Model 3 restricts the dependent variable to MNC subsidiaries matched on two or more lists as a rough characterization of the intensive margin of naming. For H1 on war relevance, the covariate of primary concern to the movement, coefficients are positive and significant, consistent with theoretical expectations of the net effect despite tension within the high cost, more audience attention cell (Figure 3). On naming motivated by potential hypocrisy (H2), the coefficient on UNGC SIGNATORY is consistently significant. On HOME–RUSSIA MISALIGNMENT, coefficients are also consistently positive and significant. On visibility, consumer orientation is consistently positive and significant (H3a). On firm size, with the

⁴²Results are robust to probit (Appendix Table E2, column 1).

⁴³In Orbis, this corresponds to having an “S”-type (state) shareholder of any state. In the analysis sample 896 observations have state ownership; 185 observations have some level of Russian state ownership alongside the FDI component.

⁴⁴In these instances, other firm- and home-level variables are coded based on the largest foreign shareholder that is the basis of selection into the sample (see dataset build replication files).

small category excluded, coefficients are positively signed as expected though significance weakens across the table. The coefficient for publicly traded firms is positive as expected but not significant. We see these weaker results as worthy of reflection. Firm size and public listing are workhorse explanations in the literature and, indeed, common sense proxies for visibility. However, results when modeling our full theory of activist targeting, which requires inclusion of a variety of other covariates of interest, suggest that size and public listing have operated in the literature as summary proxies for specific features of visibility that can be measured separately. Once those features enter the model directly, the residual effect of the proxies shrinks toward zero.

Table 1. Selection onto name-praise-shame lists

	(1)	(2)	(3: 2+ lists)
<i>High cost, more audience attention (↓↑)</i>			
H1: Industry relevant to war	0.01* (0.00)	0.01*** (0.00)	0.01** (0.00)
<i>Low cost, more audience attention (↑↑)</i>			
H2: UNGC signatory	0.60*** (0.02)	0.48*** (0.03)	0.40*** (0.05)
H3: Visibility			
H3a: Consumer-oriented industry	0.04** (0.02)	0.04** (0.02)	0.04** (0.02)
H3b: Medium	0.00 (0.01)	0.00 (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)
H3b: Large	0.10*** (0.04)	0.07** (0.04)	0.04 (0.03)
H3b: Very large	0.15** (0.06)	0.09 (0.06)	0.06 (0.06)
H3c: Publicly traded	0.05 (0.03)	0.03 (0.03)	0.01 (0.03)
H4: Home–Russia misalignment	0.05*** (0.01)	0.02* (0.01)	0.02* (0.01)
<i>High cost, less audience attention (↓↓)</i>			
H5a: Home is tax haven	-0.09*** (0.03)	-0.10** (0.04)	-0.07* (0.04)
H5b: Likely roundtripped FDI	-0.09*** (0.02)	-0.09*** (0.02)	-0.06*** (0.01)
<i>Low cost, less audience attention (↑↓)</i>			
H6: Pre-invasion sanctions	0.04 (0.11)	-0.18 (0.15)	-0.19** (0.09)
<i>Home-level controls</i>			
Home–Russia trade		0.00 (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)
Home is Ukraine		-0.07*** (0.02)	-0.07*** (0.02)
<i>Firm-level controls</i>			
Firm years in Russia (ln)		0.03*** (0.01)	0.02*** (0.01)
Corporate family presence		0.07*** (0.01)	0.05*** (0.01)
State ownership		0.00 (0.09)	0.06 (0.09)
Multiple FDI-level owners		0.05*** (0.02)	0.06*** (0.02)
FDI coded via parent		0.03 (0.03)	0.03 (0.04)
Multiple home states		0.13*** (0.02)	0.11*** (0.02)
Constant	0.11*** (0.04)	-0.07 (0.09)	-0.11 (0.12)
<i>N</i>	39736	37884	37884
<i>R</i> ²	0.34	0.40	0.34
Full controls	No	Yes	Yes
Industry FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes

Notes: OLS with industry FEs. SEs two-way clustered on corporate family and home. Named on a pro-Ukraine list at any point through the one-year anniversary.

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

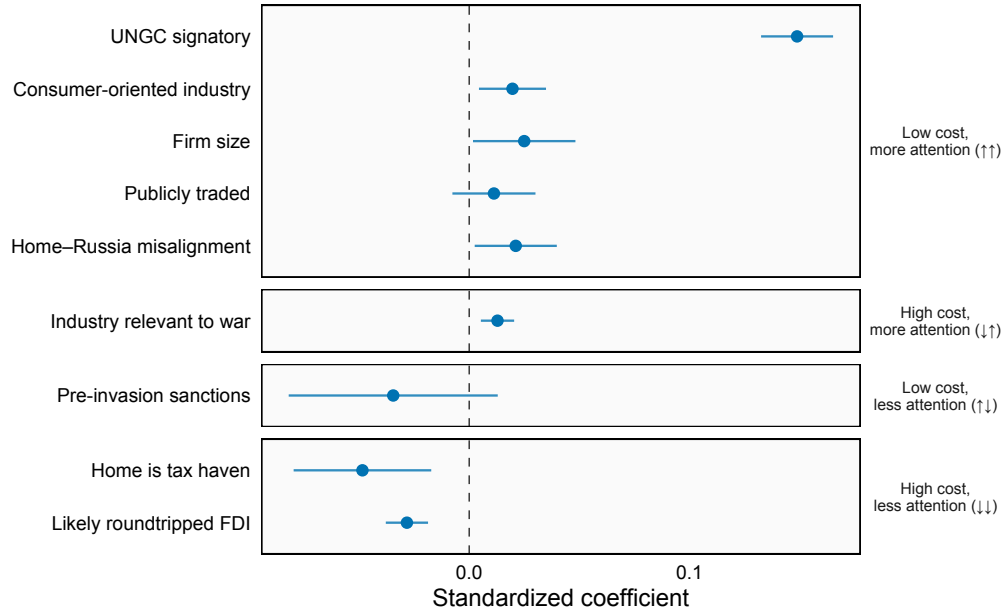
Theoretical expectations associated with the high cost, less audience attention cell are borne out. MNC subsidiaries incorporated in tax havens are significantly less likely to be named (H5a), as are MNC

subsidiaries that are likely instances of Russian capital being roundtripped through foreign-incorporated entities and reinvested in Russia as FDI (H5b). Results are less stable for firms exposed to sanctions prior to the invasion (H6), a cell characterized by internal tension. Our theoretical expectation is that the net effect on naming would be negative. In Model 3, the coefficient is negative and significant as predicted, though this is not the case in Models 1 and 2.

Next, we consider results on H7, which summarizes the observable implications of the theory for the ordering of coefficients by magnitude. Specifically, characteristics in cells where activist incentives are reinforcing should be associated with larger effects compared to those in cells with internal tensions. In Figure 4, we report standardized coefficients based on the fully specified Model 2 in Table 1. The only adjustment is the treatment of MNC subsidiary size. To facilitate clean comparison tests, we reestimate the model entering size as a linear, ordinal variable (1-4), which gives up the flexible category-by-category effects of the main results.

Read from the top to bottom, H7 expects that coefficients in the top block and the bottom block are largest in magnitude, in whatever direction; coefficients in the second and third blocks are expected to be smaller. The pattern is consistent with this expectation at the extremes of the figure. Notably, being a UNGC signatory, and thereby having publicly committed to principles of corporate social responsibility, is far and away the largest-magnitude predictor of naming. This result speaks to how meaningful the expectation that “good firms are good targets” has proven in practice, compared to other explanations.

Figure 4. Comparing coefficient magnitudes: Reinforcing versus mixed incentive cells (H7)



Notes: Full results in Appendix Table E1. 90% confidence intervals shown.

To formally explore H7, we conduct pairwise tests of the absolute value of coefficients presented

in Figure 4, comparing those in reinforcing cells to those in mixed cells.⁴⁵ Of the 14 tests, results in four are significant and consistent with H7. In four tests, the sign is as expected and results are insignificant; in the remaining six, the sign is not as expected and results are insignificant. The four significant comparisons all involve either the largest reinforcing-cell coefficient (UNGC signatory) or the smallest mixed-cell coefficient (war relevance).⁴⁶ The tests therefore support H7 where the framework’s predicted contrasts are largest, at the top and bottom of the ordering. Among the remaining comparisons, the coefficients are close to zero and to one another, and the data cannot rank them. Although, no test returns a significant result that contradicts H7.

We probe the robustness of results in Table 1 to a number of adaptations. In Appendix Table E3, we replace the latent measures of INDUSTRY RELEVANT TO WAR and HOME–RUSSIA MISALIGNMENT with their individual components. Each component block is jointly significant (Wald $p = 0.001$; $p < 0.001$). Because the components are correlated, individual component coefficients are not separately interpretable. Appendix Table E2 varies the estimator, specification, and sample. Across specifications, UNGC SIGNATORY remains the largest focal coefficient, anchoring H7. Home fixed-effects models absorb time-invariant origin-country measures, leaving other results robust. Restricting outcomes to direct name matches also preserves results, while publicly traded and pre-invasion-sanctioned firms gain significance. Dropping subsidiaries classified as small addresses the possibility that some firms had effectively zero naming probability, though activists named 19.3% of dropped firms; results remain robust, and public listing becomes significant. We also reestimate results for naming only on the three sector-specific lists.⁴⁷ Even though sectoral selection and industry fixed effects absorb much of the variation, more war-relevant industries predict naming (H1). Other results are less robust when limiting the dependent variable in this way.

5.1 Praising v. shaming

Once pro-Ukraine activists named a firm on their list, what did they say about it? Eleven of the lists in the corpus contain explicit praise alongside explicit shame.⁴⁸ We code as praised entries that have received the highest available grade on at least one pro-Ukraine list, which, depending on the list, indicates that the list authors have confirmed actual exit or believe that the firm is credibly in the process of exiting. Other “good” grades based on evidence such as the firm suspending shipments, no longer signing new contracts, or making pro-Ukraine gestures are not coded as praise. Even with this conservative coding, 53.8% of named foreign-invested firms are praised. It would be incorrect to

⁴⁵See replication files.

⁴⁶UNGC v. war, UNGC v. sanctions, roundtripped v. war, and tax haven v. war.

⁴⁷Stop Bloody Energy (fossil fuels), Putin 100 (finance), and Defuel Russia’s War (energy and finance). Appendices B.2.3, B.2.2, B.2.1.

⁴⁸The exceptions are Wikipedia (Appendix B.1.11) and the three sector-specific lists (B.2).

shorthand this as a naming and shaming movement; praise is the *majority* outcome of naming.

List makers treat praise as an instrument, not an ornament, giving it prominent visual and organizational placement.⁴⁹ Ukraine Corporate Index explicitly seeks to move investors, customers, and citizens “by praising responsible corporations while shaming irresponsible ones,” while Exit Russia links praise to accountability for firms’ commitments.⁵⁰ Coalition for Ukraine attaches “Show your support!” buttons to praised entries; RUBusiness offers praised firms assistance lifting sanctions.⁵¹ Lists also invoke peer pressure: Boycott Russia urges remaining firms to “follow [decisive companies]’ example,” while Moral Rating Agency labels first movers “Leader of Pack” and gives laggards a “Chicken Penalty.”⁵²

We have established robust determinants of naming, but do they differ when the attached judgment is praise rather than shame? The activist-targeting literature, focused on naming and shaming, is largely silent on this question.⁵³ Research on positive evaluations generally concerns certifications and clubs that firms voluntarily join (e.g., Potoski and Prakash, 2005; Bartley, 2007). In our setting, activists praised firms unprompted. Our framework nevertheless predicts naming without reference to grade: firm characteristics determine documentation costs and audience attention regardless of the eventual judgment (Figure 3). If conduct determines which firms merit an entry, the framework is misspecified. We therefore compare the determinants of being named and praised with those of being named and shamed. Results are visualized in Figure 5, which compares across theoretically motivated subsamples: first, praised firms are coded one and shamed firms excluded; second, shamed firms are coded one and praised firms excluded. Never-named firms are the comparison group in both.⁵⁴

⁴⁹Yale CELI foregrounds firms that curtailed operations; Moral Rating Agency titles its ledger “The Good, Bad and Ugly” (Appendices B.1.12, B.1.7).

⁵⁰Appendices B.1.10; B.1.5.

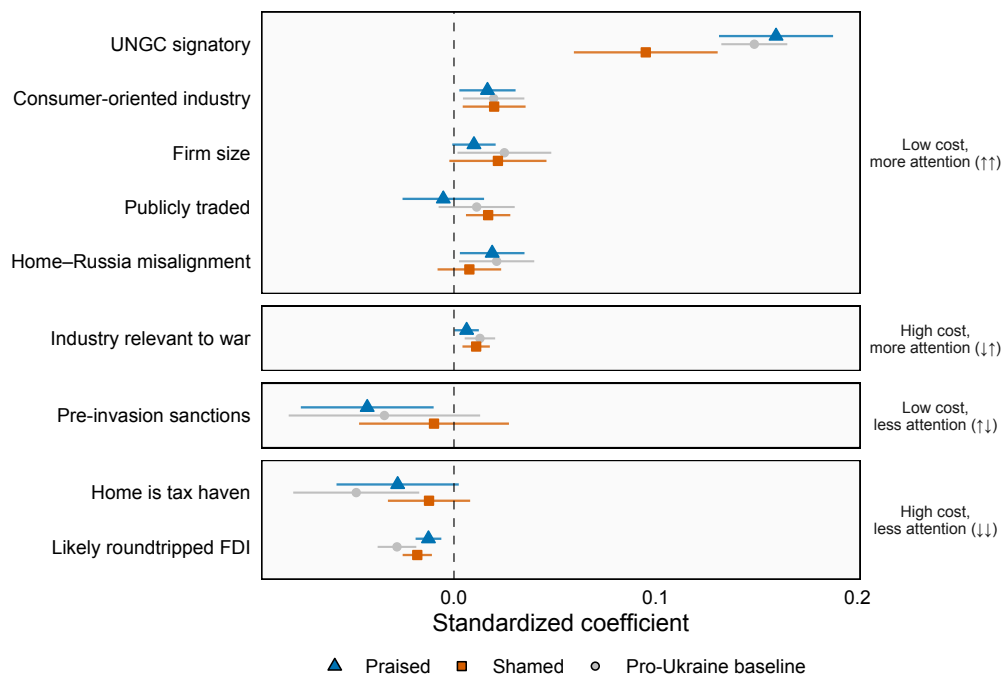
⁵¹Appendices B.1.2; B.1.8.

⁵²Appendices B.1.1, B.1.7.

⁵³Although, international-rankings scholarship engages with entities at the bottom and top of lists (Kelley and Simmons, 2020).

⁵⁴Full results in Appendix Table E1.

Figure 5. Selection into praise and shame: standardized estimates for praised (triangle) and shamed (square) firms, each versus never named, against the baseline of Figure 4.



Notes: Full results for praised and shamed models in Appendix Table E1. Gray markers reproduce the baseline of Figure 4. 90% confidence intervals.

Figure 5 supports a grade-agnostic theory of activist naming. Most prominently, UNGC SIGNATORY remains positive, significant, and relatively large in both praise and shame models. On one hand, these results suggest that good firms make good targets and get good grades.⁵⁵ On the other hand, UNGC signatories are also disproportionately more likely to be named and shamed, consistent with the argument that the potential for hypocrisy makes them useful targets. Further, other coefficients carry the same sign as the baseline estimate.⁵⁶ As for statistical significance, results are also relatively consistent with grade-agnosticism. Exceptions include FIRM SIZE and HOME IS TAX HAVEN, which are not significant in grade-specific models. HOME–RUSSIA MISALIGNMENT is not significant in the shame model. Additionally, two characteristics that are not significant in the grade-agnostic baseline reach significance: PUBLICLY TRADED predicts being named and shamed, and PRE-INVASION SANCTIONS predicts not being named and praised. Importantly, in no case are the praise and shame estimates both significant with opposite signs.

Results on praising v. shaming carry a reassurance and a challenge for the literature. The reassurance is that the determinants of selection appear grade-agnostic, so existing accounts of who gets targeted are not biased by inattention to praise. The challenge is that this is not license to leave praise

⁵⁵Descriptively, 71.1% of named UNGC signatories were praised, whereas 46.1% of named non-signatories were praised.

⁵⁶The exception is PUBLICLY TRADED, with a negative point estimate in the praise model; neither it nor the baseline estimate is statistically distinguishable from zero.

unstudied. Activists conferred praise unprompted, at their own cost, and placed it inside their theories of change, expecting it to generate peer pressure and hold firms accountable. Building theory around activists’ own theories of change, and testing activists’ implicit hypotheses, is a task the literature should take up.

5.2 Pro-Russia countermovement

The pro-Ukraine name-praise-shame movement quickly reached audiences opposed to corporate exits. Russian actors adopted the movement’s infrastructure and built their own MNC lists, consistent with scholarship predicting that opposing activist movements use similar tools (Meyer and Staggenborg, 1996; Velasco, 2023). We scrape two such “backlash to backlash” lists into a pro-Russian corpus.⁵⁷ One is from the Russian business newspaper Kommersant, and the other from a grassroots online effort, heterogeneity which reflects that of the pro-Ukraine network (Figure 2). Applying the same matching procedures, we find that 5.3% of MNC subsidiaries in the pre-invasion sample appear on pro-Russia lists.⁵⁸

Our framework (Figure 3) was developed in the setting of pro-Ukraine activists, but its cost and attention axes should be direction-agnostic. Firm search costs do not depend on the searchers’ motivation. The mechanisms we expect to drive audience attention are also direction-agnostic—conditional on the audience in question. For a pro-Russia audience, we expect that war relevance lacks the pro-Ukraine movement’s mobilizing frame and thus shifts to the low-attention cell. Therefore, we hypothesize that the pro-Russia countermovement exhibits parallelism in target selection, except on war relevance.

Qualitative evidence is consistent with this prediction. Every entry on Kommersant’s list also appears on a pro-Ukraine list.⁵⁹ At the same time, war relevance is not a visible priority: the list’s industry breakdowns do not include defense; logistics entries emphasize parcel carriers and container lines; and manufacturing entries emphasize household brands rather than security-adjacent firms. The second list, We’ll Remember Everything, grew from a decentralized grassroots effort on Russian-facing social media into a website paralleling pro-Ukraine lists.⁶⁰ Its founder frames the list as a reaction to some firms that told their Russian users to “f*** off.”⁶¹ Every entry on We’ll Remember Everything is in the pro-Ukraine corpus, with five exceptions. The additional entries are for software and cloud providers whose revoked licenses or disabled services were immediately visible to Russian customers and thus consistent with consumer-facing motivations (H3a).⁶²

⁵⁷Related activity is discussed in Appendix B.4.

⁵⁸Appendix C.1.

⁵⁹Appendix B.3.1.

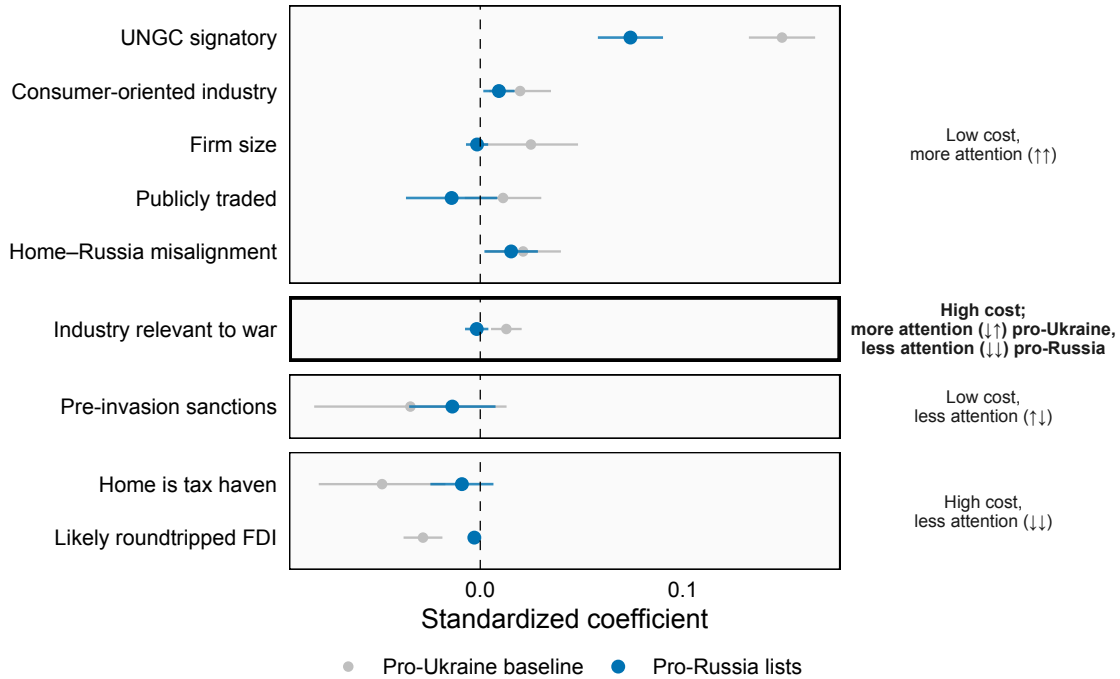
⁶⁰Appendix B.3.2.

⁶¹позволяют себе посылать на*** своих же пользователей; asterisks in the original. Founder’s announcement post, Pikabu, 8 March 2022 (Appendix B.3.2).

⁶²Qualys, ComAp, Trend Micro, Palo Alto Networks, and Zabbix (Appendix B.3.2).

Figure 6 presents results from a re-estimation of our main model where the dependent variable equals 1 if an observation matches to pro-Russia lists. As this dependent variable is a subset of the pro-Ukraine measure, plus five observations, coefficient magnitudes mechanically compress toward zero. INDUSTRY RELEVANT TO WAR is the coefficient for which we have different expectations, presuming that selecting on war-relevant firms is less, rather than more, likely to generate pro-Russian activists’ intended audience uptake (highlighted in Figure 6). It is consistent with our expectations that the point estimate for pro-Russia lists is negative, albeit insignificant.⁶³

Figure 6. Selection onto the two pro-Russia lists: standardized estimates (blue) against the pro-Ukraine baseline of Figure 4 (gray).



Notes: Full results in Appendix Table E1. Gray markers reproduce the baseline of Figure 4. 90% confidence intervals.

On other covariates of interest, we find general though not total support for expectations of parallel targeting choices. Notably, our measure of firms with public commitments to responsible corporate behavior, UNGC SIGNATORY, is again the largest-magnitude positive predictor, suggesting that both sides understand these “good firms” as “good targets,” though the potential offense differs. Results are also robust for HOME–RUSSIA MISALIGNMENT and CONSUMER-ORIENTED INDUSTRY, consistent with our expectation that underlying mechanisms are meaningful for the countermovement just as for the movement. Although, the effect of FIRM SIZE shrinks effectively to zero, and PUBLICLY TRADED turns negative though remains insignificant.⁶⁴ Our measures for obscure ownership remain negative but lose

⁶³Perhaps pro-Russia list makers wished to name and celebrate war-relevant stayers? Empirical results suggest this possibility was small enough not to override results.

⁶⁴On public listing, a reasonable post hoc explanation is that shareholders are not in the pro-Russia audience.

significance.⁶⁵

Scholarship on transnational activism tends to study one movement at a time, and often the movement whose success the scholarship’s normative thrust is meant to inform. Yet, a movement’s success is conditional in part on its countermovement, which also faces strategic choices over whom to target and how (Bob, 2012). Our results suggest that theory built on one side can in fact do much to explain the other side, given that differences in audiences are clearly defined. It is nonetheless an open question whether the parallelism we document is unique to this wartime context in which the two sides are exceptionally clearly defined.

6 Conclusions

After Russia’s dramatic escalation of its war against Ukraine in February 2022, rapidly evolving geopolitical dynamics have given new life to economic statecraft by home governments, including efforts to promote MNC decoupling and supply-chain reorganization in pursuit of foreign policy objectives (e.g., Lee, 2025; Eldes, Lee and Osgood, 2025). At the same time, a transnational activist network quickly self-organized to name and shame MNCs that remained in Russia after the invasion while praising those that exited, with the aim of constraining Russia’s war effort. This grassroots campaign provides a unique opportunity to examine the political economy of activist targeting within a well-defined candidate set of MNCs invested in pre-invasion Russia.

We build a corpus of 15 pro-Ukraine lists and document that this network named over 9,000 MNC subsidiaries within one year of the invasion. Still, the named firms are only 21.2% of a comprehensive pre-invasion sample (Wellhausen and Zhu, 2026). Even in an era of unprecedented online access to information, and even for a movement whose stated mission was to reach “every ruble,” activists were selective. Naming, praising, and shaming pressure on MNCs reflects not only moral outrage but also the strategic incentives and pragmatic limits of transnational activism.

A critical open question is whether naming, praising, and shaming actually correlate with, or even cause, changes in firm behavior. Wellhausen and Zhu (2026) find that firms named in the first several months post-invasion were in fact less likely to exit Russia within an 18-month window, with exit defined as documented evidence of changed ownership. At the same time, exit is not the only measure of effectiveness. The lists themselves track more than exit. For example, several lists editorialize on how firms reached their decisions, such as Yale CELI differentiating “Buying Time” from “Digging In”; Wikipedia and Squeezing Putin document corporate donations to Ukraine; and the Moral Rating Agency grades the moral strength of firms’ statements and actions (as does We’ll Remember Everything from

⁶⁵MNC subsidiaries with obscure ownership to pro-Ukraine audiences may be understood simply as domestic Russian for pro-Russia audiences, which suggests list makers would leave them off.

the countermovement side). A full study connecting naming to effectiveness must take into account the informational, symbolic, leverage, and accountability goals activists pursue in varying combinations (Keck and Sikkink, 1998).

At the time of writing, more than four years after the invasion, the pro-Ukraine transnational activist network persists, turning toward accountability for early praise and organizational consolidation. LeaveRussia/KSE and Yale CELI document whether those they awarded “A” grades have followed through with pledges. Several contemporary efforts draw on upstream activist lists as public goods, facilitating their downstream focus on the mission rather than novel firm-level research. The Ukrainian initiative Don’t Fund Russian Army has extended naming into official correspondence with firms’ leadership and initiation of legislative change in Ukraine.⁶⁶ The B4Ukraine coalition, which counts among its members and supporters the makers of LeaveRussia/KSE, Boycott Russia, and Ukraine Corporate Index, pairs company-by-company outreach with advocacy for stronger sanctions, in pursuit of its stated mission to “block access to the economic resources behind Russian aggression.”⁶⁷ Our snapshot of activist efforts early in the war can support further study of activist emulation, persistence, and collective action over the extended, and ongoing, war.

⁶⁶<https://dont-fund-russian.army/en/about-us/>. Accessed 12 April 2026.

⁶⁷<https://b4ukraine.org>. Accessed 25 August 2026.

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Appendix

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A AI declaration

In completing this manuscript, the authors used AI tools for several tasks: information retrieval, organization, and translation in compiling lists and profiles (Appendix B); firm-name matching (Appendix C.1); crosswalks from official industry lists to NAICS codes (Appendix D); recovering the count of firms on historical anti-apartheid lists (footnote 4); and maintaining and documenting replication materials. The tools were Anthropic’s Claude (Opus and Fable models) and OpenAI’s Codex (Sol model), used through the providers’ commercial subscription products, 2024-2026. Screenshots of Russian-language sites shown in English were translated with Google Translate. The authors reviewed every AI output.

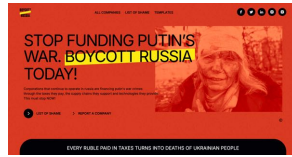
B Lists

Our data-collection window runs from Russia’s full-scale invasion on 24 February 2022 through the one-year anniversary of the invasion; as a buffer, we include updates through 31 March 2023. Information is compiled from teams’ websites and associated social-media accounts, social-media accounts maintained by project originators, legacy-media reporting, public interviews and methodological disclosures, talk-page discussions, participant-observation engagement, and Wayback Machine archives.

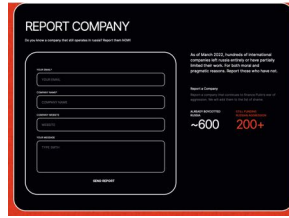
B.1 Pro-Ukraine, Comprehensive lists

B.1.1 Boycott Russia

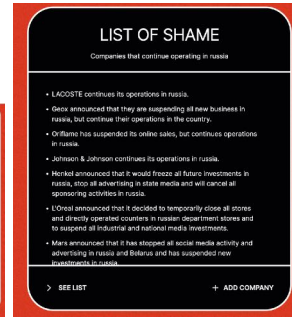
Feature	Details
Entries on list	313
Matches to Orbis sample	1,972 BVDs (4.62%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders’ location	London, UK
Originators	Founded by Highgate, a London-based strategic advisory firm; website built pro bono by Ralabs, a Lviv, Ukraine software development company, with design credited to Zgraya.
Languages	English
Key slogan	“STOP FUNDING PUTIN’S WAR. BOYCOTT RUSSIA TODAY!”
Project goals	Homepage statement: corporations operating in Russia “are financing Putin’s war crimes through the taxes they pay, the supply chains they support and technologies they provide. This must stop NOW!”
Information sources	Corporate statements and news coverage, compiled by the project itself. A “Report Company” form adds crowdsourced entries and asks users to report firms that remain in Russia.
Grading scheme	Two categories: the <i>boycott list</i> (firms that have cut ties) and the <i>list of shame</i> (firms continuing operations), with per-firm free-text rationale. The site describes the List of Shame as showing “the largest firms that continue operating in Russia.”
Top grade	On boycott list (firm has cut ties)
Additional information	Activist toolkit of pre-written social-media campaigns, template CEO letters, and sector-specific social-media accounts. Entries are organized into 12 sector categories; per-firm fields include CEO and CFO names and, for some firms, direct CEO email addresses. The homepage displays running casualty and destruction statistics under the banner “Every ruble paid in taxes turns into deaths of Ukrainian people.”



(a) Homepage



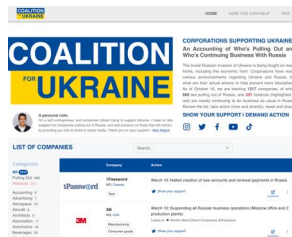
(b) “Report Company” form



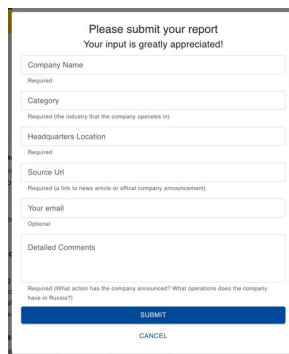
(c) List of Shame

B.1.2 Coalition for Ukraine

Feature	Details
Entries on list	1,217
Matches to Orbis sample	4,651 BVDs (10.89%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	Seattle, Washington, US
Originators	Founded and funded by Alex Algard, a Seattle-based tech entrepreneur, supporting a small professional team for web development, research, and data entry; website built by Imaginary Cloud.
Languages	English
Key slogan	Homepage headline: “Corporations Supporting Ukraine: An Accounting of Who’s Pulling Out and Who’s Continuing Business With Russia.”
Project goals	Founder’s homepage note: “I hope to rally support for companies pulling out of Russia, and add pressure on those that still remain, by providing you info to share in social media.”
Information sources	Draws on the Yale CELI dataset as an upstream source, re-curated and extended by the Coalition team; per-firm entries link to news coverage documenting each action.
Grading scheme	Binary: <i>Pulling out</i> (exiting, suspending, or materially reducing Russian operations) vs. <i>HOLDOUT</i> (continuing operations, highlighted in red), assigned from public corporate announcements. The site’s FAQ defines the threshold: a pullback counts when it is material relative to the company’s overall Russian business.
Top grade	Pulling out
Additional information	Single searchable table with a 30-category sector filter; per-firm entries include headquarters country, sector, and a pre-written tweet link (“Show your support!” for firms pulling out; “Tell them to act!” for holdouts). Entries carry reputation badges for firms appearing on the Forbes Global 2000, Fortune’s World’s Most Admired Companies, and Ethisphere’s World’s Most Ethical Companies rankings.



(a) Homepage



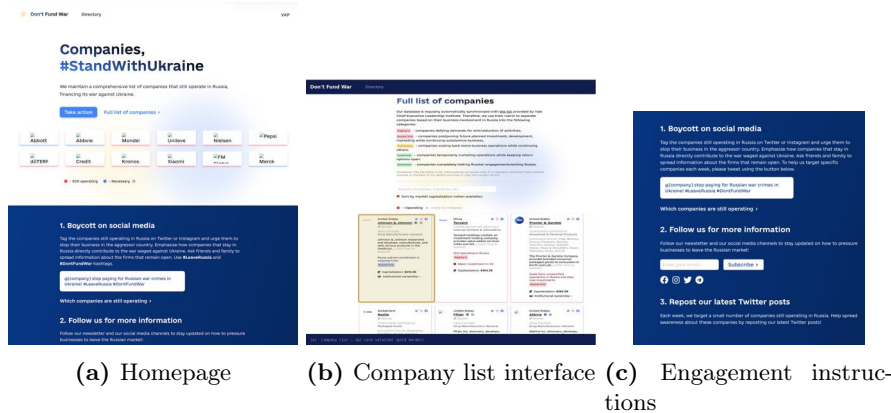
(b) Report submission form



(c) Engagement instructions

B.1.3 Don’t Fund War

Feature	Details
Entries on list	728
Matches to Orbis sample	3,624 BVDs (8.48%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	California, US
Originators	Founded and developed by Stanford University students Alex Gureev and Igor Barakaiev; later hosted by the Ukraine Support Alliance at Stanford.
Languages	English and Ukrainian (EN/YKP toggle)
Key slogan	Homepage headline: "Companies, #StandWithUkraine"
Project goals	Homepage: "We maintain a comprehensive list of companies that still operate in Russia, financing its war against Ukraine."
Information sources	Database described on-site as "regularly automatically synchronized with the list provided by Yale Chief Executive Leadership Institute," augmented by volunteer research. Per-firm cards link the company's own official statement (press release or SEC filing) and company website; a site disclaimer notes the list "may or may not contain errors."
Grading scheme	Adopts the Yale CELI rubric via the automatic synchronization: <i>Withdrawal; Suspension; Scaling Back; Buying Time; Digging In</i> .
Top grade	Withdrawal
Additional information	Company cards display logo, sector, business description, associated sub-brands, market capitalization, institutional ownership, and per-firm social-media links; a "Sort by market capitalization" toggle reorders the directory by economic weight, and a search box covers companies and industries. Firms producing life-sustaining medical goods are flagged with a blue shield and not shamed, and a second stated exception acknowledges companies whose work protects Russian citizens against government surveillance. Activism tools include a pre-written tweet template, an email newsletter, and a rotating "company of the week" feature.



(a) Homepage (b) Company list interface (c) Engagement instructions

B.1.4 EPravda

Feature	Details
Entries on list	1,389
Matches to Orbis sample	5,325 BVDs (12.46%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	Kyiv, Ukraine
Originators	Compiled by the editorial team of <i>Економічна правда</i> (Ekonomichna Pravda), a Ukrainian online business-and-economics newspaper in the Ukrainian Pravda family; no individual byline.
Languages	Ukrainian, Russian, and English (parallel versions via site language toggle)
Title of article	"Понад 1000 компаній вийшли з Росії, але не всі зупинили бізнес. Оновлюється" ("More than 1000 companies have left Russia, but not all have stopped business. Updating"); the headline count tracks the list.
Key slogan	None; framed as business journalism.
Project goals	Republication of Yale CELI's Russia-exit dataset as sortable tables, making the Yale CELI tracker accessible to Ukrainian audiences.
Information sources	Explicitly credits Jeffrey Sonnenfeld and the Yale CELI research team as the foundational source; content reproduces Yale CELI's classifications and firm entries in translation, announces that updates track Yale CELI's updates with lag.
Grading scheme	Five named, color-coded categories (green through red): <i>ceasing completely; suspending temporarily; reducing operations; continuing but not investing; continuing without restrictions</i> — paralleling the tiers of the Yale CELI rubric but excluding its letter grades.

Feature	Details
Top grade	Ceasing completely
Additional information	Published as a single evolving article. The most prominent Ukrainian-language journalistic mirror of a name-praise-shame list during the study window.



(a) Article page

Continue operations but do not invest in development
91 companies

They refrain from new investments and development, postpone planned investments, new developments, marketing activities, continuing their core business in the country.

Abbott Laboratories	suspend non-essential business activity	United States
Abbvie	suspend aesthetics operations, pause new clinical trials	United States
Accor	suspend new investments/development	France
ADM	unspecified scaling down of non-essential operations	United States
Air Liquide	Some clients no longer supplied, others scaled down; all Russian investments on hold	France
AmerisourceBergen	cease new business initiatives but continue existing clinical trials, and distributing health products	United States
Anecoop	diverting sales away from Russia	Spain

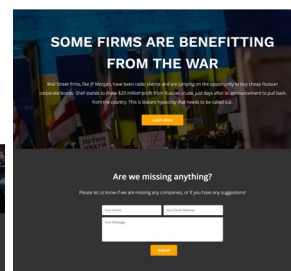
(b) Company list (English)

B.1.5 Exit Russia

Feature	Details
Entries on list	251
Matches to Orbis sample	1,647 BVDs (3.86%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	California, US (San Francisco Bay Area)
Originators	Launched and maintained by a volunteer team: Grace Lam, Polina Kulak, Nick Rogov, Andrey Voytenko, Sergey Lytynskiy, and Bogdan Govorun.
Languages	English
Key slogan	"KEEP CORPORATIONS ACCOUNTABLE FOR EXITING RUSSIA"
Project goals	Stated goal: "to ensure that corporates are accountable for walking their talk"; the homepage adds that "the private sector has a moral and ESG obligation to act."
Information sources	Corporate press releases and public statements, with every entry linked to an original source; a "Reviewed?" field flags internal verification by the team; an on-site form accepts user submissions.
Grading scheme	Five categories: <i>Committed to exit country</i> ; <i>Temporary suspension</i> ; <i>Partial suspension</i> ; <i>No new investments/businesses</i> ; <i>Continue operations</i> .
Top grade	Committed to exit country
Additional information	Per-firm fields include announcement date, sector, HQ country, key actions, share of sales from Russia, wording excerpts, and a link to the source statement. A "Strength of language" column codes how firmly each exit statement is phrased (<i>Strong</i> / <i>Medium</i> / <i>Weak</i> / <i>No official statement</i>).



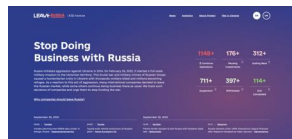
(a) Homepage



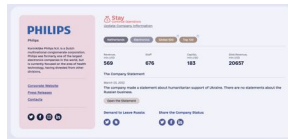
(b) User submission interface

B.1.6 LeaveRussia/KSE

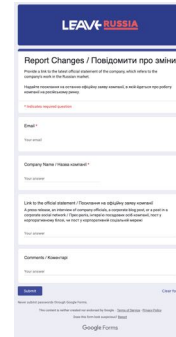
Feature	Details
Entries on list	3,128
Matches to Orbis sample	8,233 BVDs (19.27%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	Kyiv, Ukraine
Originators	Began as a volunteer project (Igor Vinnykov, Serhii Lohvin, Oleksandr Hurov, Vyacheslav Dorofeev, and Tetyana Pushkash); from July 2022 maintained by the KSE Institute SelfSanctions team at the Kyiv School of Economics, led by Nataliia Shapoval.
Languages	English and Ukrainian
Key slogan	"Stop Doing Business with Russia."
Project goals	Claims the most complete company database of foreign firms with operations in Russia, classified by degree of withdrawal.
Information sources	In-house research team performs internal investigations. Russian financial data (revenue, capital, assets, taxes paid, staff counts) drawn from the Russian Federal Tax Service and Central Bank via the official EGRUL business register; stock data from Google Finance and Yahoo Finance, with regular analysis of share prices and capitalization of parent groups. Categorization draws on public company statements, news reporting, and upstream lists the site names as feeds (Yale CELI, EPravda, Squeezing Putin, Stop Bloody Energy, and a University of St. Gallen study); a user submission form solicits information and corrections.
Grading scheme	Yale CELI rubric: <i>Exit Completed</i> (finalized disposal of Russian operations); <i>Withdrawal</i> ; <i>Suspension</i> ; <i>Scaling Back</i> ; <i>Buying Time</i> ; <i>Digging In</i> ; plus a parallel <i>Remain in RF</i> designation for firms stating they intend to continue operating.
Top grade	Exit Completed
Additional information	Filters include country, industry, Global 500, and "Top 100 in Russia by revenue"; company cards compare Russian and global revenue and staff and link official firm statements. Compiled with input from academics and specialists from Ukrainian ministries (Economy, Foreign Affairs, and Digital Transformation); part of the B4Ukraine coalition from mid-2022. The site enumerates concrete visitor actions, embeds an automated email template addressed to targeted firms, and runs a Telegram bot providing periodic updates. A joint Yale CELI-KSE methodology statement gives KSE's materiality criteria: public announcements; top taxpayers in Russia; strategic importance for the Russian economy and military production; foreign participants in Russian state tenders. It also specifies several inclusion rules: only majority foreign-owned entities (excluding Belarus), "cutting companies with Russian final beneficiaries" and companies below roughly \$5 million (at KSE's discretion, \$1 million) in annual revenue. ¹



(a) Homepage



(b) Company card



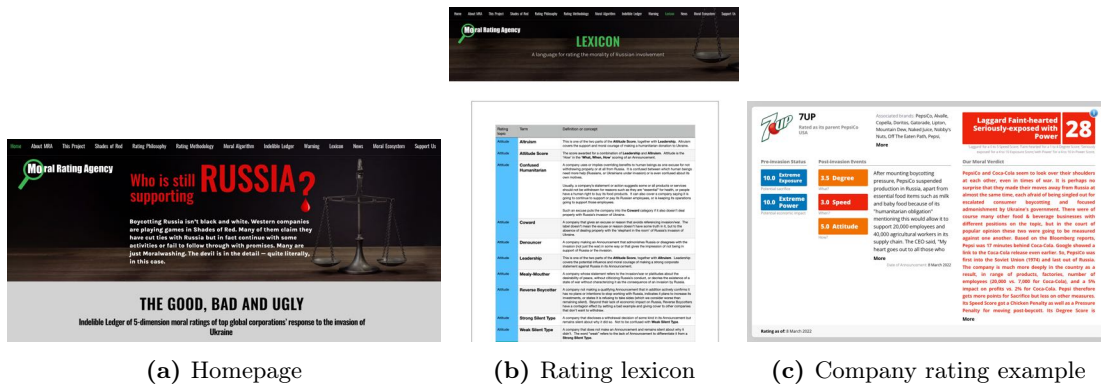
(c) User submission interface

B.1.7 Moral Rating Agency

Feature	Details
Entries on list	1,164
Matches to Orbis sample	1,186 BVDs (2.78%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	London, UK
Originators	Founded, funded, and published by Mark Dixon, a City of London mergers-and-acquisitions consultant (principal of ThinkingLinking and co-founder of BreakingViews.com).
Languages	English

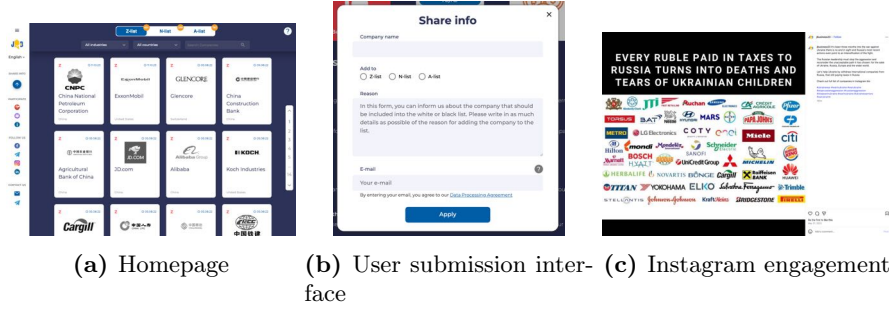
¹Sonnenfeld et al. "The Russian Business Retreat — How the Ratings Measured Up One Year Later" (February 2023), https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=4343547.

Feature	Details
Key slogan	“The Moral Rating Agency is focused on getting Russia out of Ukraine — by getting Western companies out of Russia.”
Project goals	Moral-assessment project: companies are placed into composite rating categories rather than recommended for purchase or boycott; scope stated as extending “from the top 200 companies in the world to the top 500.”
Information sources	Public corporate statements and news coverage; produces its own categorical ratings rather than aggregating upstream lists. The rating methodology credits only announced actions: a company that stops activities without announcing them “most likely will not be credited.”
Grading scheme	Composite ordinal rating built from five dimensions — <i>Speed</i> (Sprinting / Speedy / Laggard) and <i>Degree</i> (Boycotter / Near-Boycotter / Half-hearted / Faint-hearted / Shameless), annotated with modifiers for <i>Power</i> , <i>Exposure</i> , and <i>Attitude</i> — combined into 54 named category labels (e.g., <i>Sprinting Boycotter with Power</i>).
Top grade	Any category whose <i>Degree</i> = <i>Boycotter</i>
Additional information	Many entries are individual brands or sub-brands rather than parent firms. Each entry carries an ownership tag (e.g., <i>Public</i>) beside its name. The site’s term “Moralwashing” labels firms that announce Russian exit without following through, and its rating lexicon defines named attitude categories including <i>Confused Humanitarian</i> , <i>Coward</i> , <i>Denouncer</i> , <i>Mealy-Mouth</i> , and <i>Reverse Boycotter</i> . Firms disputing a rating must submit a document signed by a director of the ultimate parent company. The site’s About page states that the ratings “will be particularly powerful for publicly-traded companies or ones that have consumer brands.”



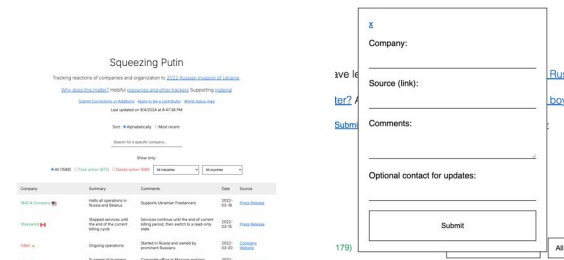
B.1.8 RUBusiness

Feature	Details
Entries on list	1,616
Matches to Orbis sample	5,161 BVDs (12.08%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	Riga, Latvia
Originators	Self-described team of “volunteer investigators” from Eastern Europe; no individuals are publicly named, and the sole public point of contact is an email address.
Languages	English and Russian
Key slogan	“EVERY RUBLE PAID IN TAXES TO RUSSIA TURNS INTO DEATHS AND TEARS OF UKRAINIAN CHILDREN.”
Project goals	Tracker of firms operating in Russia or Belarus, classified by their stated stance on the war.
Information sources	Mix of open-source research and self-described insider information via an anonymous submission form and email; claims “scrupulous investigation” and explicitly downweights company press releases as evidence.
Grading scheme	Firms are segregated into <i>Black</i> (boycott targets), <i>Gray</i> (partial/neutral), and <i>White</i> (exited) lists — presented in the site interface as <i>Z-list</i> , <i>N-list</i> , and <i>A-list</i> — with an underlying seven-point stance scale from ZZZ (“strong support” of Russia’s war) to AAA (“strong support for Ukraine”). Status is coded on five stated factors: declared position on Ukraine; office presence, hiring, and tax payments in Russia or Belarus; and Ukraine-support programs.
Top grade	AAA (“strong support for Ukraine”), within the White/A-list
Additional information	The explicit pro-war (Z/Black) classification references the marking Z on Russian military vehicles that became a public symbol of support for the war. Three stated principles: “No one will escape responsibility!”, “Nothing will be forgotten!”, and “Silence will not work!” Company-card interface with country and industry filters and employee- and revenue-size buckets. Social-media accounts name consumer-facing firms directly. Solicits donations for advertising, database maintenance, and investigative research.



B.1.9 Squeezing Putin

Feature	Details
Entries on list	1,257
Matches to Orbis sample	4,848 BVDs (11.35%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	Undisclosed
Originators	Website does not disclose individual creators or an organizing body; maintained by a distributed pool of contributors, with an on-site form to apply to become a contributor.
Languages	English
Key slogan	None; the site title functions as the tagline: "Squeezing Putin."
Project goals	Site description: "Tracking reactions of companies and organization to the Russian invasion of Ukraine." A linked "Why does this matter?" page frames corporate withdrawal, alongside state sanctions, as a way to "squeeze" Putin's administration into ending the war.
Information sources	Official company press releases and news coverage; each entry carries a "Source" link and free-text contextual comments; correction requests require a supporting link; an on-site form takes applications to become a contributor (name and contact information).
Grading scheme	Binary: <i>Took action</i> vs. <i>Needs action</i> , with free-text "Summary" and "Comments" fields carrying the granularity of what a firm has done.
Top grade	Took action
Additional information	A <i>Donations</i> column records announced Ukraine-related corporate donations per firm, with "No announcement" as the default. Tabular site interface with a national-flag icon beside every company row. The homepage notes that "a parallel list is maintained by the folks at boycotttrussia.info ," and a "List of Lists" page catalogues the other trackers, including LeaveRussia/KSE, Boycott Russia, Coalition for Ukraine, Putin 100, Wikipedia, Yale CELI, and the Moral Rating Agency, noting that they "use different methodologies" and matter for "understanding the situation holistically."



B.1.10 Ukraine Corporate Index

Feature	Details
Entries on list	236
Matches to Orbis sample	1,656 BVDs (3.88%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	United States (Progressive Shopper), Belgium (The Good Lobby), and Ukraine (KSE/LeaveRussia)

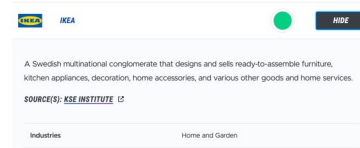
Feature	Details
Originators	Established by Progressive Shopper, a consumer-facing activist shopping platform founded by Mark Hanis; The Good Lobby, a Brussels-based civic-engagement nonprofit founded by Alberto Alemanno; and KSE Institute/LeaveRussia.
Languages	English
Key slogan	“On which side is your brand?”
Project goals	Site FAQ: “Expose the role of the private sector in response to Russia’s invasion of Ukraine. We believe that the fastest way to end the war is to stop trading with Russia, divest Russian assets and refuse to finance Putin’s regime.”
Information sources	Cites per-entry news coverage (Forbes, WSJ, Fortune, Business Insider, and others) documenting each firm’s action.
Grading scheme	Three-tier traffic light assigned by editorial staff: <i>green</i> (full exit or clear suspension: market decision, suspension, de-investment); <i>yellow</i> (partial or ambiguous: statement, relief); <i>red</i> (continues to operate: whitewashing, complicity).
Top grade	Green
Additional information	Per-firm entries include brands, Twitter handles, industry, country, the action taken, and the source underlying each classification. Progressive Shopper’s core product is a browser extension displaying brand political-contribution data while users shop; the Index extends that infrastructure to the Russia-exit question. The site carries a petition (“urge companies to stop supporting Putin’s regime”) and describes the effort as part of the Business for Ukraine (B4Ukraine) coalition.



(a) Homepage



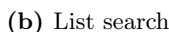
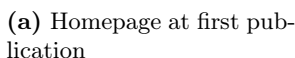
(b) Activism guidance



(c) Company card

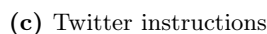
B.1.11 Wikipedia

Feature	Details
Entries on list	477
Matches to Orbis sample	2,376 BVDs (5.56%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	Worldwide (crowd-edited; no single organizational owner)
Originators	Created by Wikipedia editor DmitryShpak; contributors self-identify across multiple countries.
Languages	English
Title of article	“Corporate responses to the 2022 Russian invasion of Ukraine”
Key slogan	None; the article documents responses in neutrally worded encyclopedic prose.
Project goals	Encyclopedic documentation of corporate responses: sortable, citation-linked tables of named firms with country, industry, and action type.
Information sources	Wikipedia verifiability and citation norms: each entry requires published reliable sources (news reports, corporate statements, regulatory filings); Talk-page dispute resolution handles contested entries. The article’s two tables group firms as suspending operations in Russia (with a column recording any remaining operations) and providing donations or match funding to Ukraine. In practice the Yale CELI tracker is a heavily used reference: the article’s lead cites Yale CELI’s running counts, Yale CELI is the sole cited source for a subset of entries, and the External Links section links to the Yale CELI list.
Grading scheme	The article’s creator rejected Yale CELI-style grading: “The objective here should be to document what each company did or did not do.”
Top grade	N/A
Additional information	A precursor article, “List of companies that applied sanctions during the Russo-Ukrainian war,” created in 2015 after the Crimea annexation, absorbed early invasion-related editing before the dedicated article was created in March 2022. The article is tagged with the Wikipedia short description “Part of sanctions against Russia”; information on firms under sanctions is delegated to the sister article. Talk-page discussions during the window addressed an inclusion threshold. One contributor suggested firms with “material operations” in Russia; “Otherwise every coffee shop can be added because they placed a poster on the wall.”



B.2.1 Defuel Russia's War

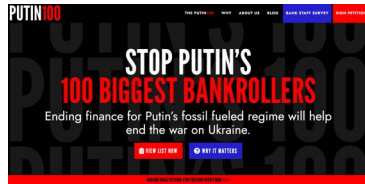
Feature	Details
Entries on list	756
Matches to Orbis sample	1,228 BVDs (2.87%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	Germany
Originators	Launched jointly by Urgewald, a German environmental and human-rights NGO (publisher of the Global Coal Exit List and Global Oil & Gas Exit List), and Ecodefense, a Russian environmental NGO designated a “foreign agent” by the Russian government in 2014.
Languages	English
Key slogan	“Defuel Russia’s War Machine”
Project goals	Advocates “an immediate and complete embargo on energy imports from Russia”: narrative pressure profiles of Western energy firms and their Russian counterparties, paired with financial-exposure tables linking Western institutions to Russian fossil-fuel firms.
Information sources	Public corporate statements and news reporting. Financing tables derive from research by the nonprofit institute Profundo based on Urgewald’s Global Coal Exit List and Global Oil & Gas Exit List, whose published methodologies set quantitative inclusion thresholds.
Grading scheme	Shame-only list with no praise tier.
Top grade	N/A
Additional information	Sub-organization by financial relationship and fuel: investors in oil & gas (bondholdings and shareholdings); banks financing oil & gas (loans and underwriting); investors in coal; banks financing coal. Associated social media accounts and calls for user activism.



B.2.2 Putin 100

Feature	Details
Entries on list	115

Feature	Details
Matches to Orbis sample	461 BVDs (1.08%)
Original publication date	Spring 2022
Founders' location	Australia, with international coalition partners
Originators	Owned by The Sunrise Project; brought to readers by a coalition including Urgewald (also behind Defuel Russia's War), Bank on Our Future, Insure Our Future, and BlackRock's Big Problem campaign; site built by 89up.
Languages	English
Key slogan	"STOP PUTIN'S 100 BIGGEST BANKROLLERS"
Project goals	"The Putin100 is a shortlist of financial institutions that support the Russian fossil fuel industry through investments, loans, insurance and other services"; designed to pressure banks, asset managers, and insurers to divest or cut exposure.
Information sources	Financial-market and disclosure data (bond and equity holdings, loan and underwriting participation) drawn from Urgewald's fossil-fuel-finance datasets (Global Coal Exit List; Global Oil & Gas Exit List). The insurance category is compiled separately from sector roles, Nord Stream 2 participation, SOGAZ reinsurance ties, and industry sources.
Grading scheme	Shame-only list with no praise tier, although several listed institutions are flagged as planning to divest at the time of inclusion on the list.
Top grade	N/A
Additional information	Categorical organization by financial relationship: <i>Bonds & Shareholdings; Loans & Underwriting; Insurance</i> . Activism elements include a sample letter to bank CEOs and online petitions (Avaaz platform, "Stop fuelling Putin's war").



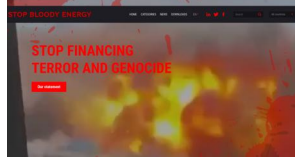
(a) Homepage



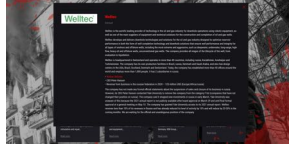
(b) "Ranking Putin's Bankrollers" list

B.2.3 Stop Bloody Energy

Feature	Details
Entries on list	51
Matches to Orbis sample	220 BVDs (0.51%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	Ukraine
Originators	Sponsored jointly by three of Ukraine's largest energy firms: DTEK Group (private energy holding), NJSC Naftogaz of Ukraine (state oil and gas), and NPC Ukrenergo (state electricity transmission). The site itself was built and maintained by contractors, the creative agency Staff Giraffe and Clapkey LLC.
Languages	English and Ukrainian
Key slogan	"STOP FINANCING TERROR AND GENOCIDE"
Project goals	Sector campaign targeting foreign firms with commercial ties to Russian fossil fuels; founding statement: "We will expose every company funding this unprovoked war in the heart of Europe."
Information sources	Per-firm free-text narrative drawing on public corporate statements, news reporting, and the founding firms' industry knowledge of Russian energy counterparties; "News" and "Downloads" sections aggregate press coverage and shareable campaign infographics. Firms are grouped into four sector buckets reflecting their tie to Russian fossil fuels: <i>Natural Gas; Coal; Oilfield Services; Mechanical Engineering</i> .
Grading scheme	Shame-only list with no praise tier.
Top grade	N/A
Additional information	Per-firm cards include company description, CEO name, Russia-related revenue, history of involvement with Russia, statement on Russia, and a link to the company website; company summaries include ownership histories, including Russian stakes in foreign firms. The campaign sponsored offline protests at targeted firms' offices, and a promotional video was shared by Ukrainian President Zelensky on his official Instagram account in April 2022.



(a) Homepage



(b) Company card

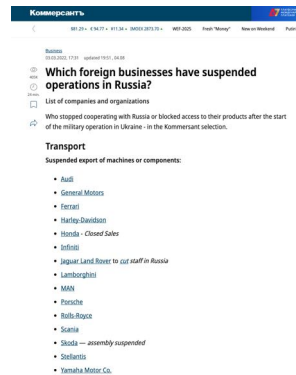


(c) Shareable infographic

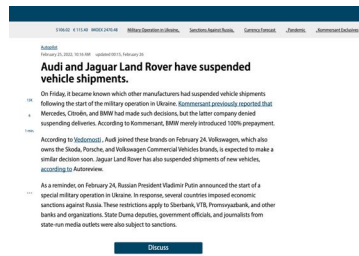
B.3 Pro-Russia

B.3.1 Kommersant

Feature	Details
Entries on list	297
Matches to Orbis sample	1,958 BVDs (4.58%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders' location	Moscow, Russia
Originators	Compiled by the editorial staff of <i>Kommersant</i> (Коммерсантъ), a daily Russian business newspaper; no individual byline.
Languages	Russian
Title of article	“Какой иностранный бизнес прервал работу в России” (“Which foreign business has interrupted its work in Russia”), subtitled “List of companies and organizations.”
Key slogan	None; a journalism article with no campaign framing.
Project goals	Sector-indexed registry of foreign firms that curtailed activity in Russia; descriptive rather than evaluative, with no stated claim to completeness. The article’s lead sets the scope as firms that “ceased cooperation with Russia or blocked access to [their] products” after the invasion.
Information sources	Each firm entry hyperlinks to a dedicated <i>Kommersant</i> reporting article as the underlying verification.
Grading scheme	N/A
Top grade	N/A
Additional information	Free-text action descriptions (e.g., “Suspension of operations in Russia”; “Freezing of production in Russia”), organized under fifteen sector headings (transport, retail, finance, IT, energy and manufacturing, pharmaceuticals, logistics, film distribution, online services, food and restaurants, media, culture and science, sports, construction, other). The article describes the invasion with the state-sanctioned term “military operation”; from 4 March 2022 Russian law criminalized describing the action otherwise.



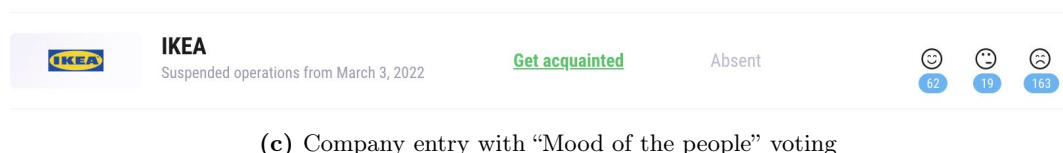
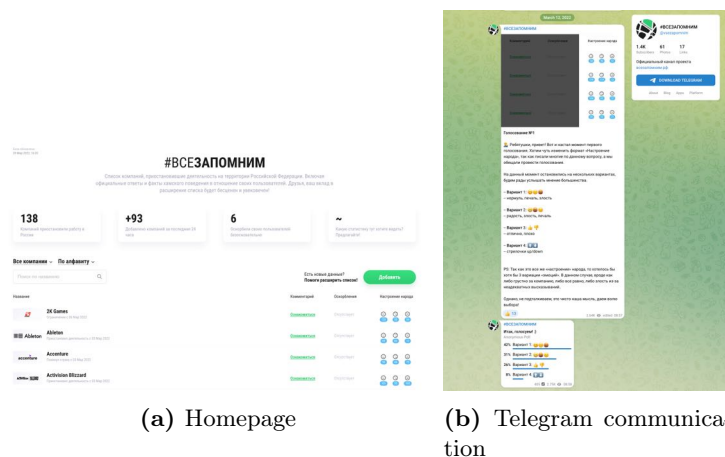
(a) Main page (English)



(b) Example of reporting (English)

B.3.2 We’ll Remember Everything

Feature	Details
Entries on list	723
Matches to Orbis sample	1,736 BVDs (4.06%)
Original publication date	March 2022
Founders’ location	Russia
Originators	Originated and promoted on Pikabu.ru , a Russian-language social news and content aggregator. Created by a Pikabu social network user identifying as “davx,” with a volunteer team handling moderation, research, and server security; not tied to any organization or sponsor. An official Telegram channel served as the project’s communications hub.
Languages	Russian
Key slogan	(English translation, landing page) “Friends, your contribution to expanding this list will be invaluable and immortalized!”
Project goals	Site self-description (English translation): “List of companies that have left the Russian market and/or acted unworthily and without honor.” The founder’s Pikabu post announcing the site describes a “reference site where you can get information about all current suspensions, blockages, and restrictions” and “a storehouse of deeds for the future.”
Information sources	Crowdsourced Russia-facing directory. Each company entry links to the firm’s official statement and carries free-text commentary and a country-of-head-office field; a submission workflow solicits URLs, country, industry, and date from users, with the site announcing moderation before publication.
Grading scheme	Entries rated as: verified suspension, block, or restriction of Russian operations. Qualitative conduct labels: respect; screwed over or failed to fulfill agreements; obscene language; aggressive statement, incitement, or calls for illegal actions; resumed operations fully or partially. A three-emoji “Mood of the people” voting column allows users to weigh in.
Top grade	N/A (pro-Russia “backlash” list)
Additional information	The project has a memorial framing: firms’ treatment of Russian consumers is documented for a post-war reckoning. The site crowdsources Russian substitutes for exited brands’ products and services. List matches to five Orbis BVDs <i>not</i> also on pro-Ukraine lists, which is exception to full-overlap rule: COMAP Systems, Trend Micro Rasha, Zabbiks, Qualys, and Palo Alto Networks.



B.4 Out of scope examples

Mainstream journalism in many languages produced structured lists of firms and packaged them for national audiences. Two exemplars of this class are in our corpus: Russia’s Kommersant, whose every firm named also appears on pro-Ukraine lists in our corpus, and Ukraine’s EPravda, which explicitly reproduces Yale CELI. Examples not in our corpus include content from the Sovcombank consumer-finance journal and Kontur business-services platform, both of which are Russia-facing. Pro-Ukraine

examples not in the corpus include exit-tracking lists published by Germany’s Tagesschau and CNN’s non-English-language services.

A number of coalition and advocacy organizations have organized public campaigns around amplifying lists; illustrative examples include *B4Ukraine* (Business for Ukraine), a coalition of civil-society organizations that draws operationally on KSE/LeaveRussia and Yale CELI data, and *Razom We Stand*, a Ukrainian campaign that partnered with Defuel Russia’s War. The NGO Business & Human Rights Resource Centre covers firms’ invasion responses in its news archives, and the NGO BankTrack retains records of S&P100 banks’ responses to the invasion.³

Ukraine’s National Agency on Corruption Prevention (NACP) list titled “War and Sanctions: International Sponsors of War” targets foreign companies that supply critical goods, services, and/or finance to the Russian state.⁴ The list is the explicit product of a state agency and thus outside the scope.

C Methodology

C.1 Firm-name matching

We match the entities named on the fifteen pro-Ukraine and two pro-Russia lists to 48,160 Orbis firm records from which the pre-invasion sample is drawn. The pipeline produces a binary indicator $list_i$ for each BVD i , equal to 1 if a list names the firm as of the end of the study period. Matching procedures were refined iteratively over a several-year period, through human and AI-assisted processes.

The fifteen pro-Ukraine and two pro-Russia lists were merged and compacted into approximately 5,300 “canonicals” which served as the basis for matching. This is an efficiency step to reduce the number of entries in circulation to match to the Orbis dataset; it does not, and need not, comprehensively account for all potential duplicates. Canonicals and the master (Orbis dataset) are both cleaned with the same name-cleaning library, which is developed endogenously and iteratively from revealed data issues. In this study, key cleaning items are issues like Cyrillic transliteration; multi-word legal-form stripping with wildcards accounting for languages with case inflection; and stripping of generic descriptors and English connectives. Language knowledge is particularly helpful in finding common issues (“Rasha” or “Rossiya” both of which mean Russia in English); AI provided considerable assistance but Russian, German, and Chinese language speakers provided several independent corrections.

In this setting, the master (Orbis dataset) is itself two sets of entries: names at the subsidiary (BVD) level and names at the parent (GUO50) level. A canonical matches to an Orbis entry if it matches at either the subsidiary or the parent level. Thus, each round of matching deals with the approximately 5,300 canonicals potentially matching to roughly 48,000 times two master entries.⁵

Matching proceeds in batches, each of which is generated via two AI-assisted passes. Pass 1 applies a deterministic token-subset rule: a canonical matches an Orbis entry when the canonical’s cleaned-name token set is a subset of the entry’s cleaned-name token set (or vice versa), with at least two shared non-generic tokens. Pass 2 extends Pass 1 to cases in which a canonical and an Orbis entry (subsidiary or parent) share only a single distinctive token, which is too weak to accept as a match alone. Each of its three rules requires that shared token plus one specific piece of corroborating evidence: (a) The canonical’s cleaned name consists only of the shared token, AND that token appears in the name of the subsidiary’s parent OR in the name of at least two sibling subsidiaries under the same parent. (b) The parent name consists only of the shared token.⁶ (c) The shared token appears in exactly one canonical across the entire canonical universe, so that uniqueness rules out competing candidates. Regardless of why a potential match fires, the AI-assisted pass surfaces potential matches to the (human) PI in a structure and format that matches the user’s preferences. For example, in this workflow the PI used AI-curated spreadsheets as well as embedded tables in the AI interface.

The PI is then responsible for adjudicating the batch. As the PI makes decisions, AI assistance

³Adding BankTrack’s records to our corpus changes no result and moves coefficients by at most 0.03 standard errors (see replication files).

⁴<https://sanctions.nazk.gov.ua/boycott/>. Last accessed March 2024.

⁵Orbis parent (GUO50) name information is incomplete.

⁶On (a) and (b), a name may consist only of the shared token because of the true entity name or as a result of the data-cleaning step.

preserves an audit trail, such that the basis for each match is reproducible and preserved for outside parties to review. For each batch, the PI can use whatever skills or information are useful to make the adjudication as to whether a match is correct or a false positive. In this setting, the PI’s previous knowledge was useful, as were targeted AI-assisted web searches for clarifying information. The PI biased toward accepting matches based on name similarities, even if PI and/or AI-informed judgments raised doubts that the Orbis entry was the intended target, presuming that Orbis entries with sufficiently similar names were more likely to feel the impact of activist targeting and thus should be included.

Exhaustion is built into the batched approach, as each batch surfaces only candidates not already locked, rejected, or taken out of circulation per the PI’s adjudications. In this setting, matching ended with a recorded disposition for every one of the canonicals: roughly 2,000 matched to at least one Orbis entry and roughly 3,300 were adjudicated as having no match in the universe.

Against false positives, a closing diagnostic resurfaces every locked pair with its evidence and a false-positive-risk score, highest-risk first, for a final human sweep. Any decisions that are reversed are included as such in the audit trail rather than overwritten. Against false negatives, two further diagnostics surface unmatched Orbis entries alongside their nearest candidate canonicals and all canonicals with zero locked firms, for a final human sweep.

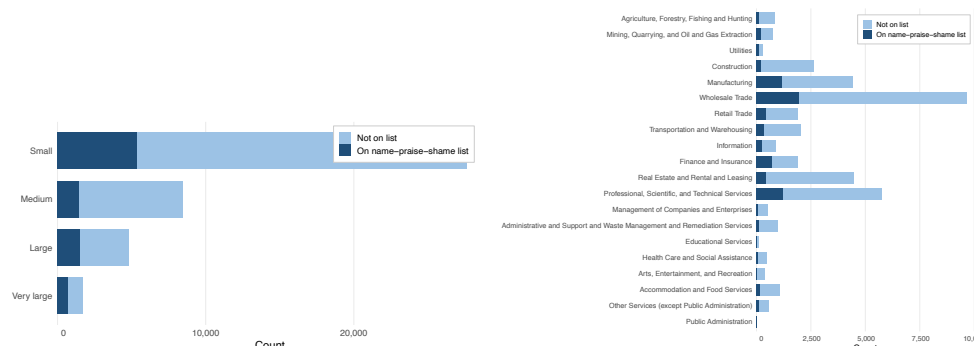
The matching procedure then allows the PI to overlay propagation rules per the research question. Here, after the matching procedure is completed, matches are propagated through corporate families such that if any one MNC subsidiary matches to a list, then all subsidiaries in the corporate family are matched.

The AI-assisted procedure replaced a previous human firm-name matching effort, conducted in 2022–2023 by a group of PIs and graduate and undergraduate research assistants, which matched canonicals derived from only 12 lists to the Orbis dataset. The AI-assisted procedure re-examined every firm flagged by the earlier effort. On the twelve lists both efforts saw, 91% of the roughly 7,800 human-coded matches survived reexamination. Of those that failed the AI-assisted procedure, the audit trail shows the most common false positive was because of false-flag token overlap, centered on more generic tokens among the canonicals. A smaller set of matches were discovered to be false after AI-assisted case-by-case ownership chain research. On false negatives: in like-for-like terms, the earlier effort found about 88% of what was findable under its own rules. A key explanation is that the AI-assisted effort facilitated more thorough Cyrillic transliteration-and-misspelling sweeps, incorporating issues entering not just via English but also the involvement of other languages like German and Chinese.

The firm-name matching procedure was repurposed to match several other rosters of firm names to the Orbis dataset. The UN Global Compact adaptation adjudicated approximately 12,000 canonicals; the OpenSanctions adaptation adjudicated approximately 7,000 canonicals; and the SIPRI Top-100 adaptation adjudicated 100 canonicals.

C.2 Orbis pre-invasion sample

We use the pre-invasion sample of foreign-invested firms in Russia as of end-2021, constructed by Wellhausen and Zhu (2026) using firm registry information from Orbis’s Historical Databases. We refer the reader to the text and appendices there for full information on database construction. Descriptive statistics illustrated in the following figures demonstrate that across important parameters, the matched subsample covers significantly less than 100% of the Orbis sample.



(a) By size (Appendix D.2)

(b) By industry (unique NAICS 2-digit)

D Definitions of variables of interest

D.1 H1: War relevance

INDUSTRY RELEVANT TO WAR is the score from an iterated principal factor analysis of five components, each defined below and each entering as a dichotomous indicator at the four-digit NAICS level: US DoD procurement; EU dual-use lists; top arms producers; FDI-restricted Russian industries; and systemically important Russian industries. Factor loadings are 0.58 (DoD), 0.66 (EU dual-use), 0.24 (top arms), 0.51 (FDI-restricted), and 0.34 (systemically important). The composite is the predicted score, standardized; each firm takes its industry’s value. Together the five components flag 170 four-digit industries: 82 are flagged by exactly one component and only five by all of them (electric power generation; engines, turbines, and power transmission equipment; aerospace; ship and boat building; computer systems design), indicating that the components capture distinct dimensions of war relevance (maximum variance inflation factor 1.32). When the components enter models jointly, the EU dual-use indicator is the only component with a positive and statistically significant coefficient (in the full and 2+-lists specifications); the remaining components are not individually distinguishable from zero (Table E3).

US DoD data is US federal procurement data for DoD contracts from the Federal Procurement Data System (FPDS) (Omari et al., 2025). We average at the four-digit NAICS industry level over 2017–2021 and code industries as 1 if their average DoD contract value exceeds the 75th percentile of the firm-level distribution. See replication materials for the resulting 51 NAICS 4-digit industries. All other industries including those with no DoD contracts are coded 0.

EU dual-use lists organize controlled items into ten categories: nuclear materials and facilities (0), special materials (1), materials processing (2), electronics (3), computers (4), telecommunications and information security (5), sensors and lasers (6), navigation and avionics (7), marine (8), and aerospace and propulsion (9).⁷ We use the version as enacted in May 2021, prior to the invasion. We use AI assistance to develop a crosswalk to four-digit NAICS industries. See replication materials for the resulting 24 NAICS 4-digit industries.

Top arms producers are the 4-digit NAICS industries of Orbis entries that are part of the corporate family of the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI) Top-100 Arms-Producing and Military Services Companies. We use the 2020 edition reporting 2020 arms revenue, released December 2021, as the pre-invasion version. SIPRI entries are matched to the Orbis dataset using the firm-name matching procedure of Appendix C.1.⁸ See replication materials for the resulting 74 NAICS 4-digit industries.

FDI-restricted Russian industries infers Russian strategic and thus presumably war-relevant industries from the point of view of FDI from Russian federal law (No. 57-FZ), as of the last pre-invasion update of 2 July 2021.⁹ Article 6 enumerates 46 business activities for which acquisition of majority foreign ownership over a Russian entity requires advance approval from the Government Commission on Foreign Investment, chaired by the Prime Minister. We use AI assistance to crosswalk items to 4-digit NAICS industries (with human review against the verbatim Russian).¹⁰ See replication materials for the resulting 51 NAICS 4-digit industries.

Systemically important Russian industries infers Russian strategic and thus presumably war-relevant industries from the Russian government’s 2020 list of systemically important organizations (системообразующие организации), which are firms eligible for state economic support should an economic

⁷Regulation (EU) 2021/821 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 20 May 2021 setting up a Union regime for the control of exports, brokering, technical assistance, transit and transfer of dual-use items (recast). OJ L 206, 11.6.2021, Annex I.

⁸Sixty-five SIPRI entries produce zero matches; this includes Russian state defense holdings that do not have FDI-level foreign shareholders (e.g., Tactical Missiles Corp., KRET, UralVagonZavod).

⁹“On the Procedure for Foreign Investment in Business Entities of Strategic Importance for the Defense of the Country and the Security of the State” (О порядке осуществления иностранных инвестиций в хозяйственные общества, имеющие стратегическое значение для обеспечения обороны страны и безопасности государства). First issued 29 April 2008. https://www.consultant.ru/document/cons_doc_LAW_76660/.

¹⁰Item 36 of Article 6 incorporates by reference the natural-monopoly registry under Federal Law 147-FZ Article 4(1), but then excludes from strategic designation five sub-categories: public telecommunications, public postal services, thermal-energy transmission, electricity distribution networks, and port services. We treat these as carve-outs of control authority that reinforce strategic-sector status, as each excluded activity is restricted to foreign investors under a separate statute or state-monopoly structure, and include the corresponding NAICS-4 codes.

crisis take place.¹¹ The list is overseen by the Ministries of Energy, Finance, Transport, Construction, Agriculture, Industry and Trade, Education, Communications, and Health. We crosswalk each of the 32 free-text sector headings categorizing the 639 firms to 4-digit NAICS codes using AI assistance (with human review against the verbatim Russian). See replication materials for the resulting 158 NAICS 4-digit industries.

D.2 H2-H4: Low cost, more audience attention cell

UN GLOBAL COMPACT (UNGC) SIGNATORY equals 1 if an MNC subsidiary (BVD) is a signatory either directly, via another subsidiary in its corporate family, or via its parent company. We reconstruct the membership list as of 31 December 2021, the boundary of the pre-invasion Orbis sample. Company and enterprise entries in the UNGC directory are matched to the Orbis dataset using the firm-name matching procedure of Appendix C.1.

A subset of members as of the reconstruction date become non-members in the subsequent period (through May 2026). In the Orbis dataset, approximately 16% of UNGC signatory observations are of this type. Results are robust to recoding later non-members to zero (see replication files).

CONSUMER-ORIENTED INDUSTRY proxies consumer orientation with advertising intensity, defined as advertising expenditures normalized by total income (Peterson and Su, 2017) and measured at the three-digit NAICS industry level using the IRS Corporation Source Book (2013). A firm is coded 1 if its industry’s advertising intensity is above the median across all industries, and 0 otherwise.

SIZE uses Orbis size categories, which classify each MNC subsidiary (BVD) into one of four categories if it meets at least one of the conditions in Table D1. While listed status is a component of the very large category, we include PUBLICLY TRADED as a separate variable of interest.

Table D1. Orbis firm size criteria

Very Large	(1) Operating Revenue $\geq$ 100 million EUR (130 million USD); (2) Total assets $\geq$ 200 million EUR (260 million USD); (3) Employees $\geq$ 1,000; (4) Listed.
Large	(1) Operating Revenue $\geq$ 10 million EUR (13 million USD); (2) Total assets $\geq$ 20 million EUR (26 million USD); (3) Employees $\geq$ 150; (4) Not Very Large.
Medium	(1) Operating Revenue $\geq$ 1 million EUR (1.3 million USD); (2) Total assets $\geq$ 2 million EUR (2.6 million USD); (3) Employees $\geq$ 15; (4) Not Very Large or Large.
Small	(1) Not included in another category.

PUBLICLY TRADED is coded 1 if the firm’s largest shareholder and/or its ultimate parent company is listed on any stock exchange outside Russia, and 0 otherwise.

HOME–RUSSIA MISALIGNMENT is the score from an iterated principal factor analysis of three components: V-Dem’s Liberal Democracy Index (Coppedge et al., 2020); the state’s UNGA voting dissimilarity with Russia (Bailey, Strezhnev and Voeten, 2017); and a dichotomous indicator of whether the state is designated as “unfriendly” by the Russian government on the “Unfriendly Countries” List (Список недружественных стран, first published 5 March 2022). Liberal democracy and UNGA dissimilarity each enter as their 2017-2021 average, and we propagate hierarchical powers’ scores to their territories.¹² The “Unfriendly Countries” list includes jurisdictions the Russian government characterizes as having taken hostile measures against Russia, its firms, or its citizens; in the Orbis dataset, 52 home jurisdictions are unfriendly.¹³

¹¹Ministry of Economic Development Letter 8952-PM/Д18и of 23 March 2020, approved by Protocol No. 3 of the Government Commission for Improving the Sustainability of Development of the Russian Economy of 20 March 2020. https://www.consultant.ru/document/cons_doc_LAW_349267/.

¹²British Virgin Islands, Cayman Islands, Bermuda, Gibraltar, and Anguilla inherit the United Kingdom’s values. Curaçao inherits the Netherlands’ values.

¹³Entities on the list in the study period: Albania; Andorra; Australia; Austria; Bahamas; Belgium; Bulgaria; Canada; Croatia; Cyprus; Czechia; Denmark; Estonia; Finland; France (and its Overseas Territories); Germany; Greece; Hungary;

The composite is the predicted score from a single-factor model, standardized; factor loadings are 0.93 (unfriendly), 0.86 (liberal democracy), and 0.68 (UNGA dissimilarity). Pairwise correlations among the components are 0.81 (unfriendly with liberal democracy), 0.61 (unfriendly with UNGA dissimilarity), and 0.59 (liberal democracy with UNGA dissimilarity). Component-level regression results appear in Table E3.

D.3 H5: Obscure ownership

HOME IS TAX HAVEN indicates that the firm’s home jurisdiction is or has been on the EU’s list of non-cooperative tax jurisdictions at any time since its original adoption in 2017 through the study period. A consequence of coding tax havens based on this list is that no EU member state is classified as a tax haven. Regional specialists agree that Cyprus has a special and important standing as a known offshore destination for Russian capital; therefore, we add it to the list.

Table D2. Tax Havens: EU List of Non-Cooperative Tax Jurisdictions + Cyprus

Albania	Curacao	Maldives	Saint Vincent and the Grenadines
American Samoa	Dominica	Marshall Islands	Samoa
Andorra	Eswatini	Mauritius	San Marino
Anguilla	Faroe Islands	Mongolia	Serbia
Antigua and Barbuda	Fiji	Montenegro	Seychelles
Armenia	Greenland	Montserrat	Switzerland
Aruba	Grenada	Morocco	Taiwan
Australia	Guam	Namibia	Thailand
Bahamas	Guernsey	Nauru	Trinidad and Tobago
Bahrain	Hong Kong	New Caledonia	Tunisia
Barbados	Isle of Man	Niue	Turkey
Belize	Israel	North Macedonia	Turks and Caicos Islands
Bermuda	Jamaica	Oman	United Arab Emirates
Bosnia and Herzegovina	Jersey	Palau	Uruguay
Botswana	Jordan	Panama	US Virgin Islands
British Virgin Islands	Korea	Peru	Vanuatu
Cabo Verde	Labuan Island	Qatar	Vietnam
Cayman Islands	Liechtenstein	Russia	<i>Addition: Cyprus</i>
Cook Islands	Macao	Saint Kitts and Nevis	
Costa Rica	Malaysia	Saint Lucia	

LIKELY ROUNDTIPPED FDI codes a foreign-invested firm as a likely roundtripper if its parent (GUO50) is Russian, or if parent information is missing in Orbis and its subsidiary-level home jurisdiction is a tax haven (Table D2). In either case, the firm must have no state ownership. Of the 42,720 foreign-invested firms in the pre-invasion sample, 10.9% are tagged as likely roundtrippers, with the largest concentration headquartered in Cyprus. The correlation between LIKELY ROUNDTIPPED FDI and HOME IS TAX HAVEN is 0.21; 19.1% of firms with tax-haven homes are tagged as likely roundtrippers.

D.4 H6: Pre-invasion sanctions

PRE-INVASION SANCTIONS is based on the OpenSanctions Consolidated Sanctions dataset (OpenSanctions, 2026), retrieved May 2026. We take the union of designated firms and individuals (1) under the Russia-, Ukraine-, and Belarus-related sanctions programs of the United States, the European Union, the United Kingdom, Australia, Canada, and Ukraine, and (2) with entity jurisdiction in Russia or Belarus under any program, and filter to designations effective before 24 February 2022. Included designations start in 1997, with the large majority following Russia’s 2014 annexation of Crimea. Matches to the Orbis dataset are propagated through the corporate family per the procedures in Appendix C.1; of the 42,720 foreign-invested firms in the pre-invasion sample, 3.8% are coded 1. We make no claim as to the nature of the sanction to which a matched firm is exposed, only that it had been exposed to adverse legal attention in the form of sanctions in the pre-invasion period.

E Additional results

Iceland; Ireland; Italy; Japan; Latvia; Liechtenstein; Lithuania; Luxembourg; Malta; Micronesia; Monaco; Montenegro; Netherlands (and Aruba, Curaçao, Sint Maarten); New Zealand; North Macedonia; Norway; Poland; Portugal; Romania; San Marino; Singapore; Slovakia; Slovenia; South Korea; Spain; Sweden; Switzerland; Taiwan; Ukraine; United Kingdom (and all Crown Dependencies and Overseas Territories); United States; all constituent states of the European Union.

Table E1. Full results for Figures 4, 5, and 6

	Baseline (Fig. 4)	Praise v. shame (Fig. 5)		Pro-Russia (Fig. 6)
	Named	Praised	Shamed	Named
<i>High cost, more audience attention (↓↑)</i>				
H1: Industry relevant to war	0.01*** (0.00)	0.01* (0.00)	0.01*** (0.00)	-0.00 (0.00)
<i>Low cost, more audience attention (↑↑)</i>				
H2: UNGC signatory	0.15*** (0.01)	0.16*** (0.02)	0.10*** (0.02)	0.07*** (0.01)
H3: Visibility				
H3a: Consumer-oriented industry	0.02** (0.01)	0.02* (0.01)	0.02** (0.01)	0.01* (0.00)
H3b: Firm size (ordinal)	0.02* (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)	0.02 (0.01)	-0.00 (0.00)
H3c: Publicly traded	0.01 (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)	0.02** (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)
H4: Home–Russia misalignment	0.02* (0.01)	0.02* (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)	0.02* (0.01)
<i>High cost, less audience attention (↓↓)</i>				
H5a: Home is tax haven	-0.05** (0.02)	-0.03 (0.02)	-0.01 (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)
H5b: Likely roundtripped FDI	-0.03*** (0.01)	-0.01*** (0.00)	-0.02*** (0.00)	-0.00* (0.00)
<i>Low cost, less audience attention (↑↓)</i>				
H6: Pre-invasion sanctions	-0.03 (0.03)	-0.04** (0.02)	-0.01 (0.02)	-0.01 (0.01)
<i>Home-level controls</i>				
Home–Russia trade	0.01 (0.01)	0.02 (0.02)	0.02** (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)
Home is Ukraine	-0.01*** (0.00)	-0.01*** (0.00)	-0.01*** (0.00)	-0.01** (0.00)
<i>Firm-level controls</i>				
Firm years in Russia (ln)	0.02*** (0.01)	0.02*** (0.00)	0.01*** (0.00)	0.01* (0.00)
Corporate family presence	0.10*** (0.02)	0.07*** (0.02)	0.06*** (0.02)	0.03* (0.02)
State ownership	0.00 (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)	0.01 (0.02)	-0.00 (0.01)
Multiple FDI-level owners	0.01*** (0.00)	0.01** (0.00)	0.01*** (0.00)	0.01** (0.00)
FDI coded via parent	0.01 (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)	-0.00 (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)
Multiple home states	0.02*** (0.00)	0.02*** (0.00)	0.01*** (0.00)	0.01*** (0.00)
Constant	0.20*** (0.01)	0.13*** (0.01)	0.12*** (0.01)	0.05*** (0.01)
<i>N</i>	37884	34678	33933	37884
<i>R</i> ²	0.39	0.40	0.19	0.20
Industry FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Notes: OLS with industry FEs. SEs two-way clustered on corporate family and home.

Standardized estimates; size entered as ordinal (1-4).

Through the one-year anniversary: named on a pro-Ukraine list (col 1); praised or shamed vs. never named (cols 2-3); named on a pro-Russia list (col 4).

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table E2. Estimator and design robustness

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
	Probit	Home FEs	Own-name DV	Restricted sample	Sectoral-list DV
<i>High cost, more audience attention</i> ($\downarrow\uparrow$)					
H1: Industry relevant to war	0.07*** (0.02)	0.01** (0.00)	0.01** (0.00)	0.01*** (0.00)	0.01** (0.00)
<i>Low cost, more audience attention</i> ($\uparrow\uparrow$)					
H2: UNGC signatory	1.45*** (0.09)	0.44*** (0.03)	0.47*** (0.03)	0.42*** (0.04)	0.15*** (0.03)
H3: Visibility					
H3a: Consumer-oriented industry	0.24** (0.10)	0.04** (0.02)	0.03* (0.02)	0.04*** (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)
H3b: Medium	0.07* (0.04)	0.01 (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)		-0.00 (0.00)
H3b: Large	0.36*** (0.12)	0.08** (0.03)	0.08** (0.03)	0.08*** (0.03)	-0.00 (0.01)
H3b: Very large	0.40* (0.22)	0.10* (0.06)	0.12** (0.06)	0.10* (0.05)	-0.01 (0.01)
H3c: Publicly traded	0.25** (0.13)	0.02 (0.03)	0.05** (0.02)	0.11*** (0.03)	0.01* (0.01)
H4: Home–Russia misalignment	0.18*** (0.06)		0.02* (0.01)	0.03* (0.02)	-0.00 (0.00)
<i>High cost, less audience attention</i> ($\downarrow\downarrow$)					
H5a: Home is tax haven	-0.49*** (0.19)		-0.07** (0.03)	-0.13*** (0.05)	-0.04** (0.02)
H5b: Likely roundtripped FDI	-0.74*** (0.15)	-0.09*** (0.02)	-0.06*** (0.02)	-0.15*** (0.04)	-0.01 (0.01)
<i>Low cost, less audience attention</i> ($\uparrow\downarrow$)					
H6: Pre-invasion sanctions	-0.86 (0.55)	-0.15 (0.15)	-0.13** (0.06)	-0.02 (0.13)	0.02 (0.06)
<i>Home-level controls</i>					
Home–Russia trade	0.03 (0.03)		0.01 (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)	-0.00 (0.01)
Home is Ukraine	-0.59*** (0.10)		-0.06*** (0.02)	-0.10*** (0.02)	-0.00 (0.01)
<i>Firm-level controls</i>					
Firm years in Russia (ln)	0.18*** (0.03)	0.02*** (0.01)	0.02*** (0.01)	0.02** (0.01)	-0.00* (0.00)
Corporate family presence	0.30*** (0.04)	0.06*** (0.01)	0.02*** (0.01)	0.06*** (0.01)	0.02** (0.01)
State ownership	-0.04 (0.30)	0.01 (0.08)	-0.18** (0.07)	-0.07 (0.09)	0.17* (0.10)
Multiple FDI-level owners	0.22*** (0.07)	0.04*** (0.01)	0.04*** (0.02)	0.08*** (0.02)	-0.01** (0.01)
FDI coded via parent	0.12 (0.12)	0.02 (0.03)	0.02 (0.03)	-0.07*** (0.02)	-0.02 (0.02)
Multiple home states	0.43*** (0.10)	0.12*** (0.02)	0.13*** (0.02)	0.11*** (0.03)	-0.01 (0.01)
Constant	-3.31*** (0.56)	-0.04** (0.02)	-0.14 (0.11)	-0.20 (0.14)	0.09 (0.09)
<i>N</i>	37884	39051	37884	14445	37884
<i>R</i> ²		0.43	0.32	0.36	0.23
Industry FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Home FEs	No	Yes	No	No	No

Notes: SEs two-way clustered on corporate family and home. Col 1: probit; cols 2-5: OLS with industry FEs.

Col 2: home FEs replace home-level variables. Col 3: direct name matches only.

Col 4: Orbis-Small firms dropped; Medium is the omitted size category.

DV: named on a pro-Ukraine list through the one-year anniversary (cols 1-4); on a sectoral list (col 5).

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table E3. Selection onto lists: components of the latent composites

	(1)	(2)	(3: 2+ lists)
<i>High cost, more audience attention</i> ($\downarrow\uparrow$)			
H1: Industry relevant to war, components:			
Defense (US DoD)	0.01 (0.01)	0.01 (0.02)	0.00 (0.01)
Defense (EU dual-use)	0.02 (0.02)	0.04** (0.02)	0.04** (0.02)
Top arms-producing industry	-0.00 (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)
Russian strategic industry (Systemic)	0.01 (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)	0.02 (0.01)
Russian strategic industry (FDI limits)	-0.01 (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)	-0.02 (0.01)
<i>Low cost, more audience attention</i> ($\uparrow\uparrow$)			
H2: UNGC signatory	0.58*** (0.03)	0.47*** (0.03)	0.39*** (0.05)
H3: Visibility			
H3a: Consumer-oriented industry	0.04*** (0.02)	0.04** (0.02)	0.04** (0.02)
H3b: Medium	0.00 (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)
H3b: Large	0.10*** (0.04)	0.08** (0.04)	0.04 (0.03)
H3b: Very large	0.15** (0.06)	0.10 (0.06)	0.07 (0.06)
H3c: Publicly traded	0.03 (0.03)	0.02 (0.03)	0.00 (0.03)
H4: Home–Russia misalignment, components:			
Home is liberal democracy	0.27*** (0.06)	0.26*** (0.06)	0.23*** (0.05)
Home–Russia UNGA dissimilarity	0.09 (0.11)	0.00 (0.10)	0.11 (0.12)
Home is unfriendly	-0.05* (0.03)	-0.10*** (0.03)	-0.10*** (0.04)
<i>High cost, less audience attention</i> ($\downarrow\downarrow$)			
H5a: Home is tax haven	-0.10*** (0.02)	-0.10*** (0.03)	-0.07** (0.03)
H5b: Likely roundtripped FDI	-0.10*** (0.02)	-0.10*** (0.02)	-0.07*** (0.01)
<i>Low cost, less audience attention</i> ($\uparrow\downarrow$)			
H6: Pre-invasion sanctions	0.04 (0.11)	-0.19 (0.16)	-0.19** (0.10)
<i>Home-level controls</i>			
Home–Russia trade		0.01 (0.00)	0.01* (0.01)
Home is Ukraine		0.03 (0.02)	0.02 (0.02)
<i>Firm-level controls</i>			
Firm years in Russia (ln)		0.03*** (0.01)	0.02*** (0.01)
Corporate family presence		0.07*** (0.01)	0.05*** (0.01)
State ownership		0.01 (0.08)	0.07 (0.09)
Multiple FDI-level owners		0.05*** (0.02)	0.06*** (0.02)
FDI coded via parent		0.03 (0.04)	0.03 (0.04)
Multiple home states		0.13*** (0.02)	0.11*** (0.02)
Constant	-0.04 (0.03)	-0.24*** (0.08)	-0.28** (0.12)
<i>N</i>	39736	37884	37884
<i>R</i> ²	0.35	0.40	0.35
Industry FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes

Notes: OLS with industry FEs. SEs two-way clustered on corporate family and home.

War-relevance and misalignment composites replaced by their components.

Named on a pro-Ukraine list through the one-year anniversary; col 3, on two or more lists.

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Appendix references

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